

ADOBE PHOTOSHOP CS 8.0

Subject: Graphic Design
DIT Part 2nd

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Photoshop CS version

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ADOBE PHOTOSHOP CS 8.0

Adobe Photoshop is a graphics editing program developed and published by Adobe Systems. In computer graphics, **graphics software** or **image editing software** is a program or collection of programs that enable a person to manipulate visual images on a computer. Computer graphics can be classified into two distinct categories: **raster graphics** and **vector graphics**. Many graphics programs focus exclusively on either vector or raster graphics, but there are a few that combine them in interesting ways. It is simple to convert from vector graphics to raster graphics, but going the other way is harder. Some software attempts to do this. Adobe Photoshop is a pixel graphic software. That works on pixels.



Important Features of Photoshop

File format

Photoshop files have default file extension as **.PSD**, which stands for "Photoshop Document." A PSD file stores an image with support for most imaging options available in Photoshop. These include layers with masks, color spaces, ICC profiles, CMYK Mode (used for commercial printing), transparency, text, alpha channels and spot colors, clipping paths, and duotone settings. This is in contrast to many other file formats (e.g. .JPG or .GIF) that restrict content to provide streamlined, predictable functionality. A PSD file has a maximum height and width of 30,000 pixels, and a length limit of 2 Gigabytes. Photoshop files sometimes have the file extension **.PSB**, which stands for "Photoshop Big" (also known as "large document format"). A PSB file extends the PSD file format, increasing the maximum height and width to 300,000 pixels and the length limit to around 4 Exabyte's.

The dimension limit was apparently chosen somewhat arbitrarily by Adobe, not based on computer arithmetic constraints (it is not close to a power of two, as is 30,000) but for ease of software testing. PSD and PSB formats are documented. Because of Photoshop's popularity, PSD files are widely used and supported to some extent by most competing software. The .PSD file format can be exported to and from Adobe Illustrator, Adobe Premiere Pro, and After Effects, to make professional standard DVDs and provide non-linear editing and special effects services, such as backgrounds, textures, and so on, for television, film, and the web. Photoshop's primary strength is as a pixel-based image editor, unlike vector-based image editors. However, Photoshop also enables the creation, incorporation, and manipulation of vector graphics through its Paths, Pen tools, Shape tools, Shape Layers, Type tools, Import command, and Smart object functions. These tools and commands are convenient when you want to combine pixel-based and vector-based images in one Photoshop document, because you may not have to use more than one program. However, if you want to create very complex vector graphics with numerous shapes and colors, you may find it easier to use software that was created primarily for that purpose, such as Adobe Illustrator, CorelDRAW or Xara Designer Pro. If you want to import the complex vector object into Photoshop, you can import it as a Smart Object. Double-click on Photoshop's layers palette to open the object in its original software, such as Adobe Illustrator. You can make changes. When you save, Photoshop will update the Smart Object.

Language availabilities: Photoshop is available in the following languages: Brazilian Portuguese, Chinese Simplified, Chinese Traditional, Czech, Danish, Dutch, English, Finnish, French, German, Hungarian, Italian, Japanese, Korean, Norwegian, Polish, Romanian, Russian, Spanish, Swedish, Turkish and Ukrainian. The Arabic, Greek, and Hebrew versions are available from Win soft.

Plugins:

Photoshop functionality can be extended by add-on programs called Photoshop plugins (or plug-ins). Adobe creates some plugins, such as Adobe Camera Raw, but third-party companies develop most plugins, according to Adobe's specifications. Some are free and some are commercial software. Most plugins work with only Photoshop or Photoshop-compatible hosts, but a few can also be run as standalone applications.

There are various types of plugins, such as filter, export, import, selection, and automation. The most popular plugins are the filter plugins (also known as a 8bf plugins), available under the Filter menu in Photoshop. Filter plugins can either modify the current image or create content. Below are some popular types of plugins, and some well-known companies associated with them:

- Color correction plugins (Alien Skin Software, Nik Software, OnOne Software, Topaz Labs Software, The Plugin Site, etc.)
- Special effects plugins (Alien Skin Software, Auto FX Software, AV Bros., Flaming Pear Software, etc.)
- 3D effects plugins (Andromeda Software, Strata, etc.)

Adobe Camera Raw (also known as ACR and Camera Raw) is a special plugin, supplied free by Adobe, used primarily to read and process raw image files so that the resultant images can be processed by Photoshop. You use Camera Raw by opening an image file, rather than using the 'Filter' menu. Like other plugins, Camera Raw's help information is in the 'Help > About Plug-In' menu (as "Camera Raw"). You can use Camera Raw also by Adobe Bridge, by clicking on any image and selecting 'File > Open in Adobe Camera Raw'.

Tools

Upon loading Photoshop, a sidebar with a variety of tools with multiple image-editing functions appears to the left of the screen. These tools typically fall under the categories of **cropping and slicing; drawing; painting; measuring and navigation; selection; typing; and retouching**. Some tools contain a small triangle in the bottom right of the toolbox icon. These can be expanded to reveal similar tools. While newer versions of Photoshop are updated to include new tools and features, several recurring tools that exist in most versions are discussed below.

Cropping and Slicing

The *crop* tool can be used to select a particular area of an image and discard the portions outside of the chosen section. This tool assists in creating a focus point on an image and excluding unnecessary or excess space. The "*slice*" and *slice select* tools, like the crop tool, are used in isolating parts of images. The slice tool can be used to divide an image into different sections, and these separate parts can be used as pieces of a web page design once HTML and CSS are applied. The slice select tool allows sliced sections of an image to be adjusted and shifted.

Drawing

Photoshop includes a few versions of the *pen* tool. The pen tool creates precise paths that can be manipulated using anchor points. The *freeform pen* tool allows the user to draw paths freehand, and with the *magnetic pen* tool, the drawn path attaches closely to outlines of objects in an image, which is useful for isolating them from a background.

Measuring and Navigation

The *eyedropper* tool selects a color from an area of the image that is clicked, and samples it for future use. The *hand* tool navigates an image by moving it in any direction, and the *zoom* tool enlarges the part of an image that is clicked on, allowing for a closer view.

Selection

The *marquee* tool can make selections that are single row, single column, rectangular and elliptical. Once an area of an image is highlighted, the *move* tool can be used to manually relocate the selected piece to anywhere on the canvas. The *lasso* tool is similar to the marquee tool, however, the user can make a custom selection by drawing it freehand. In addition, the lasso tool can make magnetic and polygonal selections.

Typing

Photoshop also provides tools for adding and editing text. The *type* tools create an area where text can be entered, and the *type mask* tools create a selection area that has the shape of text. The type tool creates vector-based text, so symbols, letters and numbers in various fonts and colors can be re-sized while maintaining the same resolution.

Retouching

There are several tools that are used for retouching, manipulating and adjusting photos, such as the *clone stamp*, *eraser*, *burn*, *dodge*, *smudge* and *blur* tools. The clone stamp tool samples a selected portion of an image, and duplicates it over another area using a brush that can be adjusted in size, flow and opacity. The smudge tool, when dragged across part of an image, stretches and smudges pixels as if they are real paint, and the blur tool softens portions of an image by lowering the amount of detail within the adjusted area. The eraser

tool removes pixels from an image, and the *magic eraser* tool selects areas of solid color and erases them. The burn and dodge tools, which are derived from traditional methods of adjusting the exposure on printed photos, have opposite effects; the burn tool darkens selected areas, and the dodge tool lightens them.

Content-Aware

Content-awareness is a useful aspect of Photoshop where image editing is done automatically and intelligently. It comes in two forms which are content-aware scaling and content-aware filling, in which elements in a background automatically recompose according to the areas a user of the program decides to fill or scale. More specifically, content-aware scaling works by rescaling an image and causing its content to adapt to the new dimensions and preserving important areas of it. Content-aware filling functions by matching tone, color, and noise of an area of the image that contained an object or detail in which the user decides to remove.

Healing Tools

With improvement retouching tools like the *Clone Stamp* tool and *Healing Brush* tool, imperfections of an image can easily be removed. These tools essentially function by locating a source point (or multiple source points) that can be scaled or rotated in order to cover an imperfection or unwanted detail in a specific area of an image.

Puppet Warp

Similar to the content-aware tool, the *puppet warp* tool reveals Photoshop's intelligence by allowing a user to reposition an object in an image such as a flower or arm. This is done by

using points that outline the structure of an object and easily repositioning in the wanted orientation.

Video Editing

In Adobe CS5 Extended edition, video editing is comprehensive and efficient with a broad compatibility of video file formats such as *MOV*, *AVI*, *FLC*, *MPEG-4*, and *FLV* formats and easy workflow. Using simple combination of keys video layers can easily be modified, with other features such as adding text and the creation of animations using single images.

3D

With the Extended version of Photoshop CS5, 2D elements of an artwork can easily become three-dimensional with the click of a button. Extrusions of texts, an available library of materials for three-dimensional and even wrapping two-dimensional images around 3D geometry are all possible with this version of Photoshop. Realism can also be added to an image using the 3D features of Photoshop such as animating image-based lights and depth of field.

Mobile Integration

Third-party plugins have also been added to the most recent version of Photoshop where technologies such as the iPad have integrated the software with different types of applications. Applications like the Adobe Eazel painting app allows the user to easily create paintings with their fingertips and use an array of different paint from dry to wet in order to create rich color blending.

Camera Raw

With the Camera Raw plug-in, RAW images can be processed without the use of Adobe Photoshop Light room, along with other image file formats such as *JPEGs*, *TIFFs*, or *PNGs*. The plug-in allows users to remove noise without the side-effect of over-sharpening, add grain, and even perform *post-crop vignetting*.

Techniques



Extraction of foreground and manipulation of both foreground (artistic filter) and background (blur)

Extracting

A widely used technique is extraction. By this technique a part of the image, normally the foreground, such as a person, is isolated from the rest of the image and put on a new background. Alternatively both background and the extracted foreground can be manipulated and put back together as shown on the example. To make the extraction a line must be drawn around the foreground figure to select it. Several tools can be used for this process for instance the lasso tool; however, in this case the filter-extraction tool has been used. The latter is normally the preferred tool for extracting figures with hair or fur.

Cultural impact

Photoshop and derivatives such as *Photoshopped* (or just *Shopped*) have become verbs that are sometimes used to refer to images edited by Photoshop, or any image manipulating program. "Photoshop" is also used as a noun to refer to image editing programs in general. Such derivatives are discouraged by Adobe because, in order to maintain validity and protect the trademark from becoming genericized, trademarks must be used as proper adjectives.



A landscape photo composited and manipulated in Photoshop

Photoshop art has become popular. For example, Tao Lin has a column employing only *Photoshop* for captioned pieces of art for Vice Magazine. Flickr features many groups devoted to *Photoshop* art, including one with over 11,000 members.

Graphic design

Photoshop has been a useful tool for graphic designers to create artwork conveniently and aesthetically. For example, a studio based in Barcelona called Vasava use Photoshop in order to visualize their vision on an initial concept and then move onto different media to complete the concept. The studio takes traditional art and pushes the limits on the medium in order to create artwork for print and web. Some of the many other graphic design studios that use Photoshop are Zee Design and American Greetings.

Magazines

Before any type of print media is published, whether it is a magazine, newspaper, or even novel it is likely the case that Photoshop has been used to enhance and clean up the imagery on many if not all of the pages. Magazines use Photoshop and many of its tools in order to enhance the imagery and text in their publications. Many Health and Beauty Magazines employ in-house designers to retouch photos of models to enhance their beauty. They add finishing touches to the imagery by using tools that balance color and add drop shadows, among other edits.

Photoshop Disasters

This is done by readers of the website who send emails to the administrator of the site who find these disasters. Many of the disasters range from missing limbs to incorrect composition to overdone photo retouching on fashion models among the many others presented on the website.

Versions of Photoshop

CS1

The first Photoshop CS was commercially released in October 2003. Photoshop CS increased user control with a reworked file browser augmenting search versatility, sorting and sharing capabilities and the Histogram Palette which monitors changes in the image as they are made to the document. Match Color was also introduced in CS, which reads color data to achieve a uniform expression throughout a series of pictures. Photoshop CS integrated Camera Raw version 2.0 functionality, which enabled direct manipulation of raw media in an greater set of professional-grade digital cameras. With the implementation of Layer Comps, it was easier to quickly capture design variants in a single file, then create

alternates for clients to review. Eye-catching typographic designs were possible thanks to the new ability to manipulate fully editable text on any path or inside any closed path. Photoshop CS enabled photographers to work more closely with raw media from even more digital cameras and included extensive editing support for 16-bit color images. Color levels across images could be synchronized effortlessly with the new Match Color and Shadow/Highlight features, to cure exposure problems while maintaining mid-tones. Photoshop CS is a tool that helps design sequences for videos and films by removing the guesswork for film and video professionals. The non-square pixels, typically found in videos, have been a reoccurring challenge when trying to accurately create imagery to display on screens since computer-generated graphics tend to appear distorted. With non-square pixel support in Photoshop CS, videographers could see the image as it would appear on the destination device. The 16-bit support in Photoshop CS preserves the rich color palette of film and the product is closely integrated with Adobe's industry-leading video editing applications: Adobe Premiere Pro, Adobe Encore DVD and Adobe After Effects.

CS2

Photoshop CS2, released in May 2005, expanded on its predecessor with a new set of tools and features. One of which's included an upgraded Spot Healing Brush, which is mainly used for handling common photographic problems such as blemishes, red-eye, noise, blurring and lens distortion. One of the most significant inclusions in CS2 was the implementation of Smart Objects, which allows users to scale and transform images and vector illustrations without losing image quality as well as create linked duplicates of embedded graphics so that a single edit updates across multiple iterations.

Adobe had also responded to feedback from the professional media industry by implementing non-destructive editing as well as the producing and modifying of 32-Bit High Dynamic Range (HDR) images, which are optimal for 3D rendering and advanced compositing. FireWire Previews could also be viewed on a monitor via a direct export feature.

Photoshop CS2 also brought the Vanishing Point and Image Warping tools. Vanishing Point makes tedious graphic and photo retouching endeavors much simpler by letting users to clone, paint and transform image objects while maintaining visual perspective. Image Warping makes it easy digitally distort an image into a shape by choosing on-demand presets or by dragging control points.

The File Browser had been upgraded to Adobe Bridge, which functioned as a hub for productivity, imagery and creativity, providing multi-view file browsing and smooth cross-product integration across Adobe Creative Suite 2 software. Adobe Bridge also provides access to Adobe Stock Photos, a new stock photography service that offers users one-stop shopping across five elite stock image providers to deliver high-quality, royalty-free images for layout and design (see separate press release).

Camera Raw version 3.0 was also a new addition to CS2, and it allowed settings for multiple raw files to be modified simultaneously. In addition, processing multiple raw files, to other formats including JPEG, TIFF, DNG or PSD, could be done in the background without executing the Photoshop itself.

Photoshop CS2 also brought a streamlined interface, making it easier to access features for specific instances. In CS2 users were also given the ability to create their own custom presets, which was meant to save time and increase productivity.

CS3

Smart Objects display filters without altering the original image (here on Mac OS X)

CS3 improves on features from previous versions of Photoshop and introduces new tools. One of the most significant is the streamline interface which allows increased performance, speed, and efficiency. There is also improved support for Camera RAW files which allow users to process images with higher speed and conversion quality. CS3 supports over 150 RAW formats as well as JPEG, TIFF and PDF. Enhancements were made to the Black and White Conversion, Brightness and Contrast Adjustment and Vanishing Point Module tools. The Black and White adjustment option improves control over manual grayscale conversions with a dialog box similar to that of Channel Mixer. There is more control over print options and better management with Adobe Bridge. The Clone Source palette is introduced, adding more options to the clone stamp tool. Other features include the nondestructive Smart Filters, optimizing graphics for mobile devices, Fill Light and Dust Busting tools. Compositing is assisted with Photoshop's new Quick Selection and Refine Edge tools and improved image stitching technology.

CS3 Extended includes everything in CS3 and additional features. There are tools for 3D graphic file formats, video enhancement and animation, and comprehensive image measurement and analysis tools with DICOM file support. The 3D graphic formats allow 3D content to be incorporated into 2D compositions. As for video editing, CS3 supports layers and video formatting so users can edit video files per frame.

CS3 and CS3 Extended were released in April 2007 to the United States and Canada. They were also made available through Adobe's online store and Adobe Authorized Resellers. Both CS3 and CS3 Extended are offered as either a stand-alone application or feature of Adobe Creative Suite. The price for CS3 is US\$649 and the extended version is US\$999. Both products are compatible with Intel-based Macs and PowerPCs, supporting Windows XP and Windows Vista.

CS4

CS4 features smoother panning and zooming, allowing faster image editing at a high magnification. The interface is more simplified with its tab-based interface making it cleaner to work with. Photoshop CS4 features a new 3D engine allowing the conversion of gradient maps to 3D objects, adding depth to layers and text, and getting print-quality output with the new ray-tracing rendering engine. It supports common 3D formats; the new Adjustment and Mask Panels; Content-aware scaling (seam carving); Fluid Canvas Rotation and File display options. The Content-aware scaling allows users to intelligently size and scale images, and the Canvas Rotation tool makes it easier to rotate and edit images from any angle.

Adobe released Photoshop CS4 Extended, which has the features of Adobe Photoshop CS4, plus capabilities for scientific imaging, 3D, motion graphics, accurate image analysis and high-end film and video users. The faster 3D engine allows users to paint directly on 3D models, wrap 2D images around 3D shapes and animate 3D objects. As the successor to Photoshop CS3, Photoshop CS4 is the first x64 edition of Photoshop on consumer computers for Windows. The color correction tool has also been improved significantly.

CS4 and CS4 Extended were released on October 15, 2008. They were also made available through Adobe's online store and Adobe Authorized Resellers. Both CS4 and CS4 Extended are offered as either a stand-alone application or feature of Adobe Creative Suite. The price for CS4 is US\$699 and the extended version is US\$999. Both products are compatible with Intel-based Mac OS X and PowerPCs, supporting Windows XP and Windows Vista.

CS5

A 2D landscape designed in Adobe Photoshop CS5 Extended.

Photoshop CS5 was launched on April 12, 2010. In a video posted on its official Face book page, the development team revealed the new technologies under development, including three-dimensional brushes and warping tools.

In May 2011, Adobe Creative Suite 5.5 (CS5.5) was released, with new versions of some of the applications. Its version of Photoshop, 12.1, is identical to the concurrently released update for Photoshop CS5, version 12.0.4, except for support for the new subscription pricing that was introduced with CS5.5.

CS5 introduces new tools such as the Content-Aware Fill, Refine Edge, Mixer Brush, Bristle Tips and Puppet Warp. The community also had a hand in the additions made to CS5 as 30 new features and improvements were included by request. These include automatic image straightening, the Rule-of-Thirds cropping tool, color pickup and saving an 16-bit image as a JPEG. Another feature includes the Adobe Mini Bridge which allows for efficient file browsing and management.

CS5 Extended includes everything in CS5 plus features in 3D and video editing. A new materials library was added, providing more options such as Chrome, Glass, and Cork. The new Shadow Catcher tool can be used to further enhance 3D objects. For motion graphics, the tools can be applied to over more than one frame in a video sequence.

CS5 and CS5 Extended were made available through Adobe's online store, Adobe Authorized Resellers and Adobe direct sales. Both CS5 and CS5 Extended are offered as either a stand-alone application or feature of Adobe Creative Suite 5. The price for CS5 is US\$699 and the extended version is US\$999. Both products are compatible with Intel-based Mac OS and Windows XP, Windows Vista, and Windows 7.

CS6

On March 21, 2012, Adobe released a beta version of Photoshop CS6. It adds new creative design tools and a redesigned interface with a focus on enhanced performance. New features have been added to the Content-Aware tool such as the Content-Aware Patch and Content-Aware Move.

Adobe Photoshop CS6 also brings suite of tools for video editing. Color and exposure adjustments, as well as layers are among a few things that are featured in this new editor. Upon completion of editing, the user is presented with a handful of options of exporting into a few popular formats.

CS6 brings the "straighten" tool to Photoshop, where a user simply draws a line anywhere on an image, and the canvas will reorient itself so that the line drawn becomes horizontal, and adjusts the media accordingly. This was created with the intention that users will draw

a line parallel to a plane in the image, and reorient the image to that plane to easier achieve certain perspectives.

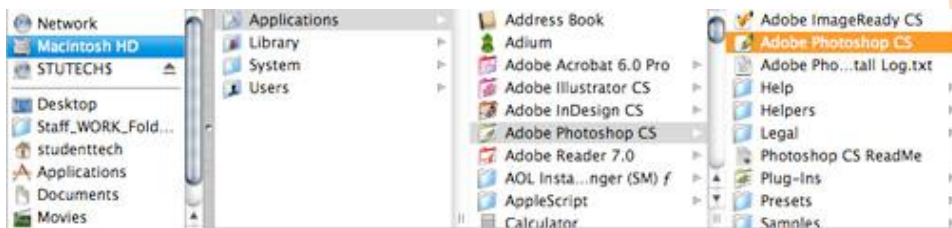
CS6 also allows background saving, which means that while another document is compiling and archiving itself, it is possible to simultaneously edit an image. CS6 also features a customizable auto-save feature, preventing any work from being lost.

Adobe has responded to feedback from graphic designers and has modified the User Interface accordingly. Now, it boasts a more unified, static look, and is easier to keep track of all the palettes and documents.

Begin by opening Adobe Photoshop CS.

On a PC, click Start > Programs > Adobe > Photoshop CS, or click on the shortcut on the desktop.

On a Mac, click Macintosh HD > Application > Adobe Photoshop CS > Adobe Photoshop CS shown in Figure 1, or click the icon in the Dock.



SETTING UP THE DOCUMENT

Setting up your document correctly from the start will make your job much easier as you work through your project. This will require some advanced planning. For example, if your final output will be a brochure, you may need to set up your document to be horizontal and double-sided.

To create a new document, click File > New. This will open the Document Setup dialog box.



Here you will be able to name your file, set up the correct page size, and orientation for your document. Options include, but are not limited to:

Page Size and Orientation

Change the page size by typing in new values for width and height. Page size represents the final size you want after bleeds or trimming other marks outside the page. In the Preset dropdown menu you can find such common sizes as letter, legal, tabloid, etc. Typing in exact values for Height and Width gives you more control over the size and orientation of your page.

Resolution

Resolution is a number of pixels on a printed area of an image. The higher the resolution, the more pixels there are on the page, the better is the quality of the image. However, high resolution increases the size of the file. The standard recommended resolution for printed images is 150 - 300, for web images - 72.

Color Mode

Choose a color mode that will best fit your project. For example, when making a graphic for a web site, choose RGB. When making an image for print, choose CMYK.

Background Contents

Choose the background: white, color, or transparent.

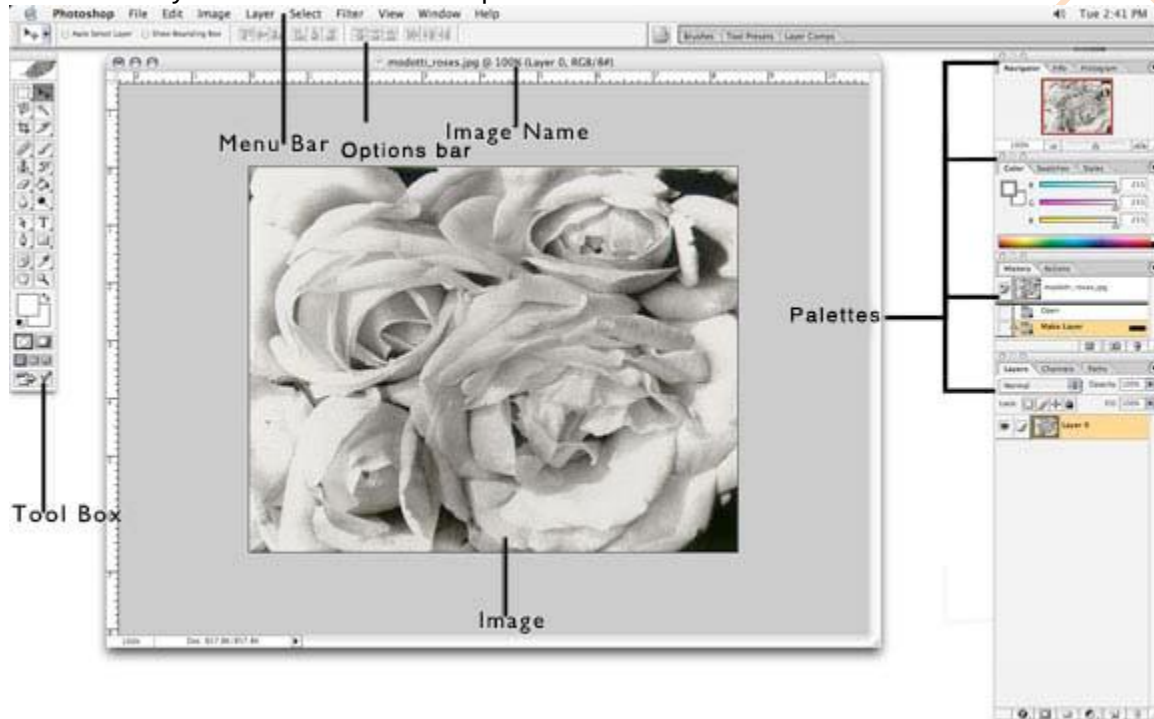
When you have entered all of your document settings, click OK.

OPENING AN IMAGE FROM A DISK

If the image you have is saved on a disk, select File > Open, and then navigate to the disk drive where your image is saved. Choose the image file and click Open. At this point, you may want to save your image under a different name so that you can always have the original to fall back on in case of a mistake. To save your file, select File > Save As and type in the new name of the file in the dialogue box. Now you should be ready to go.

INTERFACE / LAYOUT OF PHOTOSHOP

This is the layout of Adobe Photoshop interface.



Menu Bar

If you look at the top of the screen you will see the Menu bar which contains all the main functions of Photoshop, such as **File**, **Edit**, **Image**, **Layer**, **Select**, **Filter**, **View**, **Window**, and **Help**.

Tool Bar

Most of the major tools are located in the **Tool** bar for easy access.

Options Bar

The Options bar contains extra options for most tools. The options change as different tools are selected. Some tools share the same settings in the options bar, for example, painting modes and opacity, the others have specific options, for example, the **Auto Erase** setting for the **Pencil** tool.

The Image

The image will appear in its own window once you open a file.

Image Name

The name of any image that you open will be at the top of the image window as shown above.

Palettes

Palettes contain functions that help you monitor and modify images. By default, palettes are stacked together in groups. These are the palettes that are usually visible: **Navigator, Color, Histogram, Layer**. If none of the palettes are visible, go to **Window** in the **Menu** bar and choose palettes you need to work with.

PALETTES

Below is the description of the most commonly used palettes in Adobe Photoshop CS. Palettes used for more advanced image editing will be covered in the Adobe Photoshop CS Tutorial - Intermediate.

NAVIGATOR

The Navigator palette (Figure 1) allows you to resize and move around within the image. Drag the slider, click on the Zoom In and Zoom Out icons, or specify the percentage to navigate in the image.

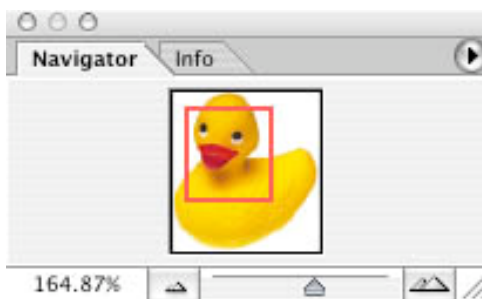


Figure 1. Navigator palette

COLOR, SWATCHES, STYLE

The Color palette (Figure 2) displays the current foreground and background colors and RGB values for these colors. You can use the sliders to change the foreground and background colors in different color modes. You can also choose a color from the spectrum of colors displayed in the color ramp at the bottom of the palette.

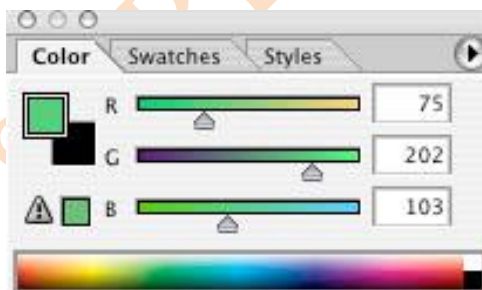


Figure 2. Color palette

In the Swatches palette (Figure 3) you can choose a foreground or background color or add a customized color to the library.



Figure 3. Swatches palette

The Styles palette (Figure 4) allows you to view, select, and apply preset layer styles. By default, a preset style replaces the current layer style. You can use the styles in the palette or add your own using the Create New Style icon.

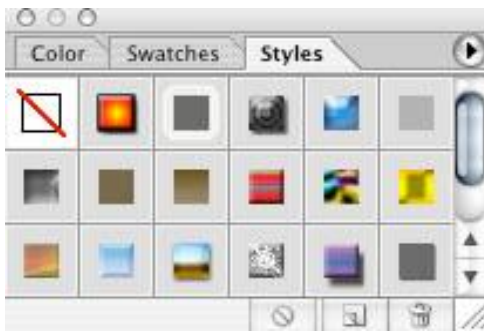


Figure 4. Styles palette

HISTORY

The History palette (Figure 5) stores and displays each action performed allowing you jump to any recent stage of the image alteration. The alterations should be created during the current working session; after saving or closing the document the History palette clears all the contents. Each time you apply a change to an image, the new state of that image is added to the palette. The History palette can store up to 20 stages. However, you can always go back to the first stage, for example opening the document. It is important to know that once you click on any of the previous stages, all the changes that were made after it will be lost.

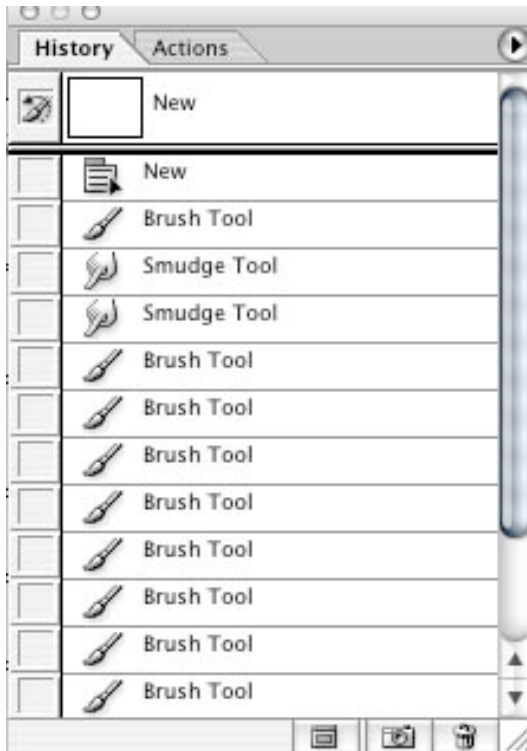
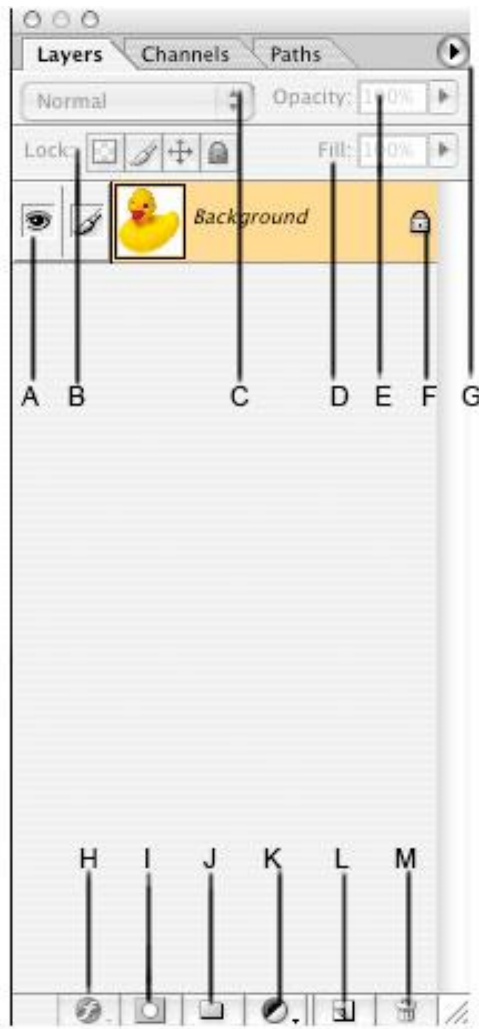


Figure 5. History palette

LAYERS

Layers let you organize your work into distinct levels that can be edited and viewed as individual units. Every Photoshop CS document contains at least one layer. Creating multiple layers lets you easily control how your artwork is printed, displayed, and edited. You will use the Layers palette (Figure 6) often while creating a document, so it is crucial to understand what it does and how to use it.



A) **Layer Visibility** - the eye shows that the selected layer is visible. Click on or off to see or to hide a layer.

B) **Layer Locking Options** - click the checkered square icon to lock **Transparency**; click the brush icon to lock the **Image**; click the arrow icon to lock the **Position**; click the lock icon to lock all options.

C) **Layer Blending Mode** - defines how the layer's pixels blend with underlying pixels in the image. By choosing a particular blending mode from the dropdown menu you can create a variety of special effects.

D) **Fill** - by typing in a value or dragging the slider you can specify the transparency of the color of the image or object.

E) **Opacity** - by typing in a value or dragging a slider you can specify the transparency of the entire layer.

F) **Layer Lock** - the icon shows when the layer is locked and disappears when it is unlocked. Double-click the icon to unlock the layer.

G) **Layer Options Menu** - click the black triangle to see the following options: **New Layer**, **Duplicate Layer**, **Delete Layer**, **Layer Properties**, etc. Some of the options are presented as icons at the bottom of the **Layers** palette.

H) **Layer Styles** - if a layer has a style, an "F" icon shows at the bottom of the **Layers** palette. Click the little black triangle to see style options.

I) **Layer Mask** - a grayscale image, with parts painted in black hidden, parts painted in white showing, and parts painted in gray shades showing in various levels of transparency.

J) **Layer Set** - this option helps to organize images with multiple layers. Click the icon to create a folder for several layers.

K) **Create New Fill or Adjustment Layer** - have the same opacity and blending mode options as image layers and can be rearranged, deleted, hidden, and duplicated in the same manner as image layers. Click the icon and select an option to create a new fill or adjustment layer.

L) **Create New Layer** - click this icon to create a new layer.

M) **Delete Layer** - to delete a layer, select a layer in the **Layers** palette and drag it to the trash can icon; or, select a layer and click the icon.

TOOLBOX

If you used other Adobe products, such as Illustrator or InDesign, you should be familiar with the toolbox in Photoshop CS as it shares some of the tools from these applications. If you are a novice user of Adobe products you should keep in mind that you might not need to use all the tools. In this tutorial, only the basic tools will be discussed in depth. To view detailed descriptions of the tools in the toolbox click on section of tools you wish to learn about.



Link to : www.adobe.com

Selection tools

Alteration tools

Drawing and Selection tools

Assisting tools

Color boxes and Modes

Some tools in the toolbar have additional "hidden" tools. These tools have small black triangles in the right-hand corner. To view the "hidden" tools, click and hold down on any tool that has a black triangle in the corner (Figure 1).

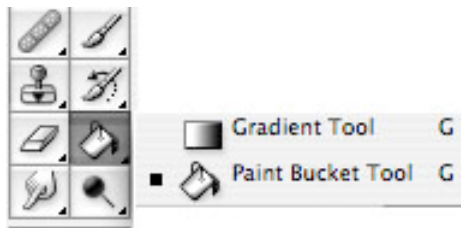


Figure 1. "Hidden" tools



SELECTION TOOLS

BUTTON	TOOL	DESCRIPTION
	Marquee	Selects an object by drawing a rectangle or an ellipse around it. Click the tool button, choose a rectangular or an elliptical marquee. Drag the marquee over the area of the image you wish to select.
	Move	Used to select and move objects on the page. Click the tool button, then click on any object on the page you wish to move.
	Lasso	Selects an object by drawing a freehand border around it. Click the tool button, drag to draw a freehand border around the are of the image you wish to select.
	Polygonal Lasso	Selects an object by drawing a straight-edge border around it. Click the tool button, click on the starting point on the image, drag to draw a straight-edge border, click and drag again to select the are of the image you wish to select. Double-click to finish.
	Magnetic Lasso	Selects an object by drawing a border that snaps to the edges of the defined area of the object. Click on the starting point on the image, drag around the are of the image. The tool will make fastening points at the edges. To finish selecting, drag the border to the starting point and click precisely in the point.
	Magic Wand	Selects all objects in a document with the same or similar fill color, stroke weight, stroke color, opacity, or blending mode. By specifying the color range, or tolerance, you can control what the Magic Wand tool selects. Click the tool button, then click on the area of the image you wish to select.
	Crop Tool	Selects and cuts parts of an image. Click the tool button, then click and drag the tool over the part of the image that you want to keep. Resize the selected area dragging the squares at the sides and corners. Click the RETURN key when your crop box is sized correctly.
	Slice Tool	Used to cut images into slices, which can be exported to a web page.

ALTERATION TOOLS

BUTTON	TOOL	DESCRIPTION
	Healing Brush	Corrects small blemishes in scanned photos. Select the tool, hold down the ALT key and left-click on the base color you need to heal. Then left-click over the blemish.
	Brush Tool	Draws lines of different thicknesses and colors. Select the tool. Then click on the selected area, drag to draw lines. Use the Options bar to change the Brush , Mode , Opacity , and Flow .
	Clone Stamp	Takes a sample of an image and applies over another image, or a part of the same image. Select the tool. Hold down the ALT key and left-click on a certain point of the document where you want to start your copy point. Then, put your mouse over whatever part of the new document you want the picture to go to. Hold down the left mouse button and drag the mouse across the page to copy the picture.
	Art History	Paints over an image using the source data from a specified history state or snapshot. Select the tool, specify the Brush , Blending Mode , Opacity , Style , Area , and Tolerance .
	Erase Tool	Removes part of an existing path or stroke. You can use the Erase tool on paths, but not on text. Select the tool, click on the part of the image you wish to erase. Drag to erase pixels.
	Paint Bucket Tool	Fills and entire area with a specific color of your choice. Select the tool. Choose a foreground color in the Color Box . Select an area you wish to apply the color to. Click the tool button, then click on the selected area.
	Gradient Tool	Applies a gradient fill to a selected part of the image or to an entire layer. Select an area you wish to apply gradient to, click the tool button, choose a fill in the Options bar, click on the starting point, hold the mouse down and drag to the end point.
	Blur Tool	Blurs the sharp edges of an image. Select an area where you wish to apply the tool. Click the tool button, choose the Brush , Mode , and Strength . Drag the brush along the edges.



Dodge Tool

Lightens areas in an image

SARDAR AZEEM(P.I.C.T)

DRAWING AND SELECTION TOOLS

BUTTON	TOOL	DESCRIPTION
	Direct Selection Tool	Selects paths and path segments. Select the tool, click anywhere on the path.
	Type Tool	Types text on a page. Every time you click the Type Tool on a new portion of the page a new layer will be created. Select the tool, click on the page and begin to type. You can specify the font and size in the Options bar. You can also resize and transform the text box by dragging the squares at the sides and corners. Use the Move Tool to move the text on the page.
	Pen Tool	Draws smooth-edged paths. Select the tool, click on the page, drag to draw a path. Click and drag the anchor points to modify the path.
	Rectangle Tool	Draws a rectangle shape. Other shapes that are hidden in this tool are: Rounded Rectangle Tool, Ellipse Tool, Polygon Tool, Line Tool, and Custom Shape Tool. Select the tool, click and drag on the page to draw a shape. The shape will be automatically filled with the current foreground color.

ASSISTING TOOLS

BUTTON	TOOL	DESCRIPTION
	Notes Tool	Serves as a comment feature. Usually used for electronic text edits. Select the tool, click on the spot on the page where you wish to make a comment. Type in the text box.
	Eyedropper Tool	Takes color samples from colors on the page and displays them in the Color Boxes. Select the tool, click on the color in the image you wish to sample. The Color Box will display this color.
	Hand Tool	Allows you to move around within the image. Select the tool, click on the spot on the page, hold the mouse button down, drag to move in the area.
	Magnifying Glass Tool	Magnifies or reduces the display of any area in your image window. Select the tool, choose Zoom In or Zoom Out in the Options bar, click on the area of the image you wish to magnify or reduce.

COLOR BOXES AND MODES

BUTTON	TOOL	DESCRIPTION
	Color Boxes	The foreground color appears in the upper color selection box and represents a color that is currently active. The background color appears in the lower box and represents an inactive color. To change the foreground color, click the upper color selection box in the toolbox. To change the background color, click the lower color selection box in the toolbox. To reverse the foreground and background colors, click the Switch Colors icon (the arrow) in the toolbox. To restore the default foreground and background colors, click the Default Colors icon (the little black and white boxes) in the toolbox. NOTE: If you are using the Gradient Tool, the currently selected foreground and background colors will be the default colors of the gradient.
	Modes	Edit in Standard Mode and Edit in Quick Mask Mode are used for modifying images in the unmasked or masked area. Standard Screen, Full Screen with Menu Bar, Full Screen are used for viewing larger or smaller are of the image. Edit in ImageReady is used to transfer the file for editing in Adobe ImageReady.

BASIC IMAGE EDITING

Now that you know how to find your way around in the Photoshop interface and are familiar with the most common commands, pallets, and tools, you can start doing some basic image editing. In the next few chapters of this tutorial you will learn how to crop, resize, correct, and sharp/blur your images.

Click on one of the links below to connect to a corresponding chapter.

Cropping

Resizing

Correcting

Sharpening/Softening

CROPPING

Cropping is one of the most basic editing techniques that can improve your images. Cropping helps to bring out the most important features in your image and focus the viewers' attention on these features. Cropping also allows you to make your image a standard photo size.

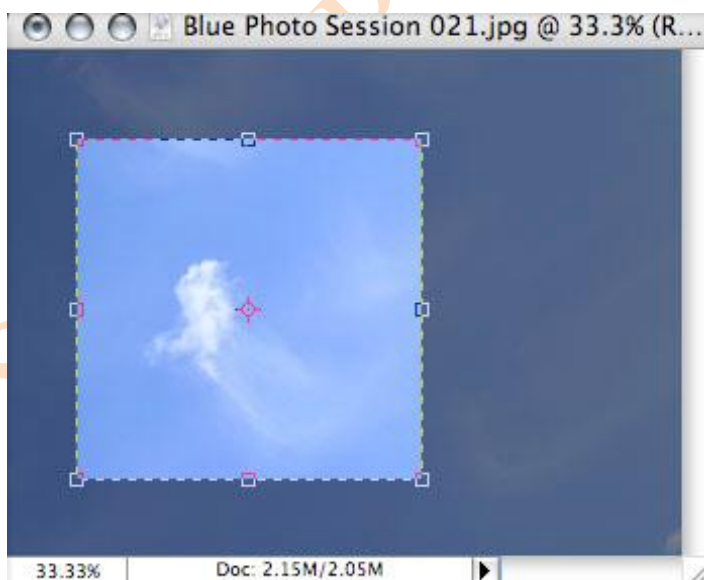
There are several ways to crop images in Adobe Photoshop:

1. Cropping with the Crop Tool
2. Cropping to a specific size
3. Cropping with the Marquee Tool

CROPPING WITH THE CROP TOOL

The Crop Tool allows you to make a precise selection of an image you wish to edit. To crop with the Crop Tool, follow these steps:

1. Open the image you wish to crop (see Getting Started for detailed instructions).
2. Select the Crop Tool from the Toolbox (see Selection Tools for location and description).
3. Click on your image once and drag the mouse out to make a cropping border



4. Resize the border by dragging the squares at the sides and corners till you are satisfied with the way your image looks.

NOTE: You can also rotate your cropping border. Move the cursor outside the border, you will see how it turns into a double-headed arrow (Figure 2). Drag the arrows in the directions you wish to rotate your selection.

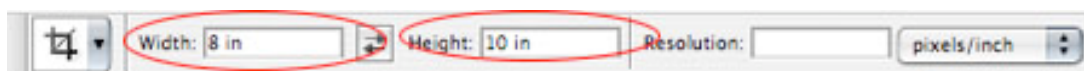


5. Once you are completely satisfied with your cropped image, press ENTER.

CROPPING TO A SPECIFIC SIZE

If you wish to print your digital photos or other images on standard size photo paper, you will have to crop your images to a specific size, such as 8x10. To crop an image to a specific size, do the following:

1. Open the image you wish to crop.
2. Select the Crop Tool from the Toolbox.
3. In the Options bar, specify the values for Width and Height.



4. Click in your image and drag the cropping border. Notice that the border is

constrained - you cannot make it wider or longer than the specified values (Figure 4). For example, if you entered 8 for Width and 10 for Height, whatever size you make the border, the area within it will fit on an 8x10 photo.

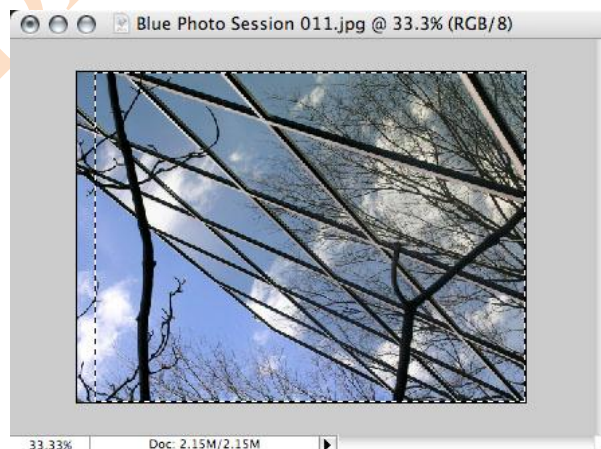


5. Once you are completely satisfied with your cropped image, press ENTER.

CROPPING WITH THE MARQUEE TOOL

If you are in a hurry and need just a simple crop, you can use the Marquee Tool and a menu command. To crop with the Marquee Tool, follow the steps below:

1. Open the image you wish to crop.
2. Select the Rectangular Marquee Tool from the Toolbox (see Selection Tools).
3. Click in your image and drag the mouse to draw a marquee around the area you wish to crop.



4. In the main menu, go to Image > Crop (Figure 6). The image will be immediately cropped.



RESIZING

Resizing in Photoshop can help you print your images in standard photo sizes, resize and preserve the high quality of digital photos, and enlarge small images to a poster size.

RESIZING TO A SPECIFIC SIZE

To resize your image to a preset size, follow the steps below:

1. In the main menu, go to File > New.
2. In the New dialog box, click on the Preset dropdown menu. You will see several preset sizes, such as 2x3, 4x6, 5x7, 8x10 with the preset resolution of 300 ppi.



Figure 1. Preset size in the New dialog box

3. Choose the size that you wish and click **OK**.

NOTE: All the preset sizes are in portrait orientation. If you wish to resize an image with the landscape orientation, you need to create your own preset. To create your own size, do the following:

1. Type in the values for **Width** and **Height**, for example 7x5.
2. Type in your desired resolution (150 ppi is enough for high quality printing, and 72 ppi is good for the web images).

3. Click the **Save Preset** button (Figure 2).

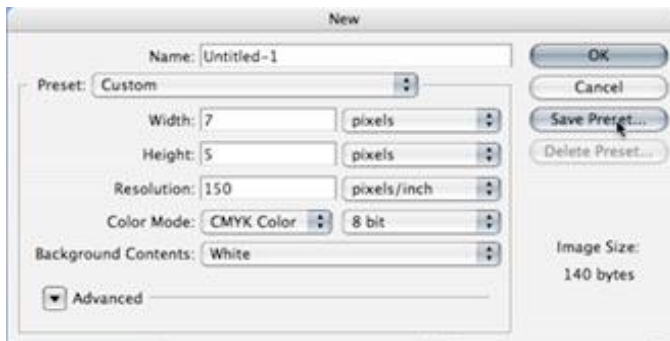


Figure 2. Saving a preset size

RESIZING DIGITAL PHOTOS

Digital photos usually have large dimensions but low resolution, 72 ppi, which effects their quality when their size is decreased or increased. When printed, the photos with the changed size will look pixilated. To resize the digital photos without loosing the quality, follow these steps:

1. Open the digital photo you wish to resize.
2. In the main menu, go to **View > Rulers**. You will be able to see the dimension of your photo (Figure 3).



Figure 3. Dimensions of a digital photo - 11.111 x 8.333

3. In the main menu, go to **Image > Image Size**.

4. In the **Image Size** dialog box, check the **Resample Image** box off (Figure 4). Type in your desired resolution (anything between 150 and 300 ppi). The photo is now 6.667 x 5 inches.

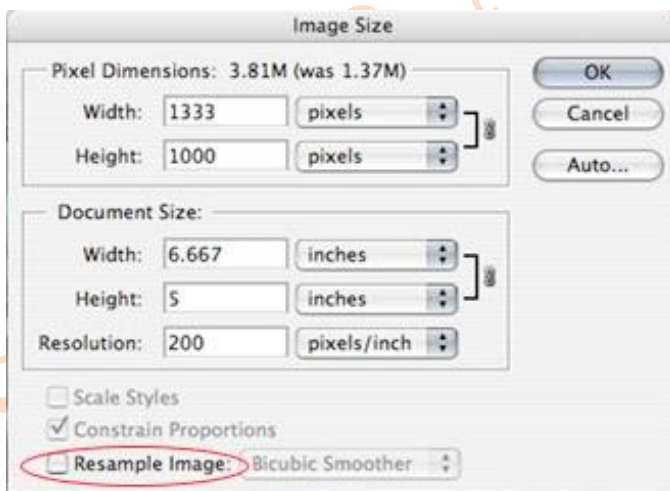


Figure 4. Changing resolution.

ENLARGING

If you want to make your digital photo into a poster size image, you can do it in the **Image Size** dialog box. However, just increasing the dimensions will make the image appear blurry and pixilated. To enlarge the image without losing the quality, follow these steps:

1. Open the digital image you wish to enlarge.
2. In the main menu, go to **Image > Image Size**.
3. In the **Image Size** dialog box, make sure the **Resample Image** box is checked off and choose **Bicubic Smoother** from the dropdown box (Figure 5).

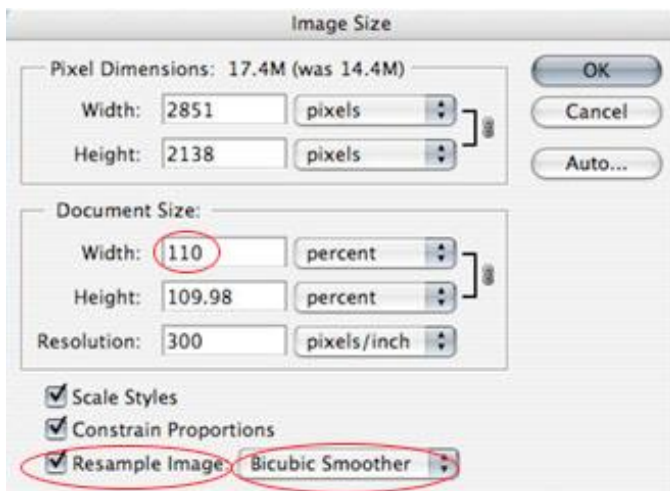


Figure 5. Increasing the size by 10 percent

4. Change the **Document Size** measurements to **Percent**. Type in 110; this will increase the size of the image by 10 percent (Figure 5).
5. Continue enlarging by 10 percent till you are satisfied with the size.

CORRECTING

Digital cameras tend to cause various problems, such as "red eye" or "hot spots", if you use flash, or underexposure, if you don't. In Photoshop, you can correct these problems, as well as adjust the overall color of your digital photo.

RED EYE REMOVAL

The digital camera flash is located right above the lens, which causes the "red-eye"; however, you can fix your photos easily in Photoshop. To remove the "red eye", follow the steps below:

1. Open a photo you wish to correct.
2. Select the **Zoom Tool** from the **Toolbox**. Click and drag to draw a rectangle around the eye (Figure 1).



Figure 1. Red eye zoomed in

3. Make sure your default **Foreground** and **Background** colors are black and white (Figure 2).



Figure 2. Foreground and Background colors set to black and white

4. Click on the little black triangle of the **Healing Brush Tool** button and select the **Color Replacement Tool**.
5. Click on the red and paint, holding down the mouse button. You will see how the red will disappear (Figure 3).



Figure 3. Red eye corrected

6. Repeat the steps for the other eye.

HOT SPOT REMOVAL

Using a flash can also cause another problem - shiny areas on people's faces or the flash reflection in the shiny surfaces. To correct this problem, follow the steps below:

1. Open the photo you wish to correct.
2. Select the **Clone Stamp Tool** from the **Toolbox**.
3. In the **Options** bar, change the **Blend Mode** from **Normal** to **Darken** (Figure 4).

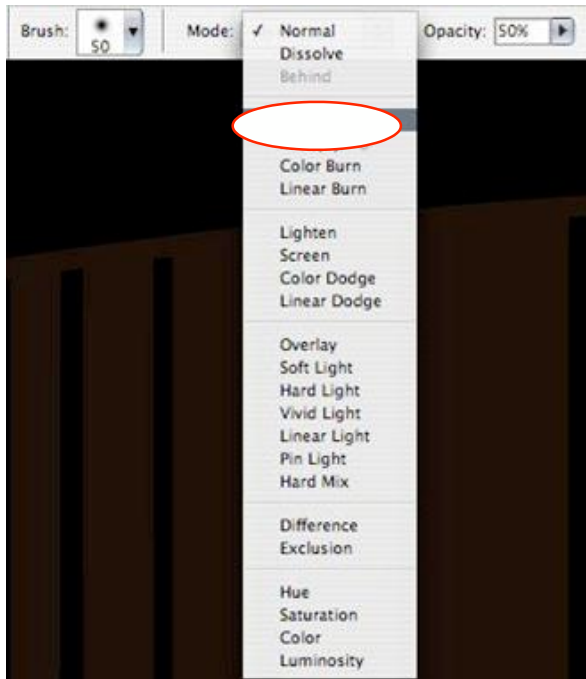


Figure 4. Setting the options for the Clone Stamp Tool

4. Set the **Opacity** to 50 percent.
5. Choose a soft-edged brush, set the diameter to 40 or 50 (Figure 5).

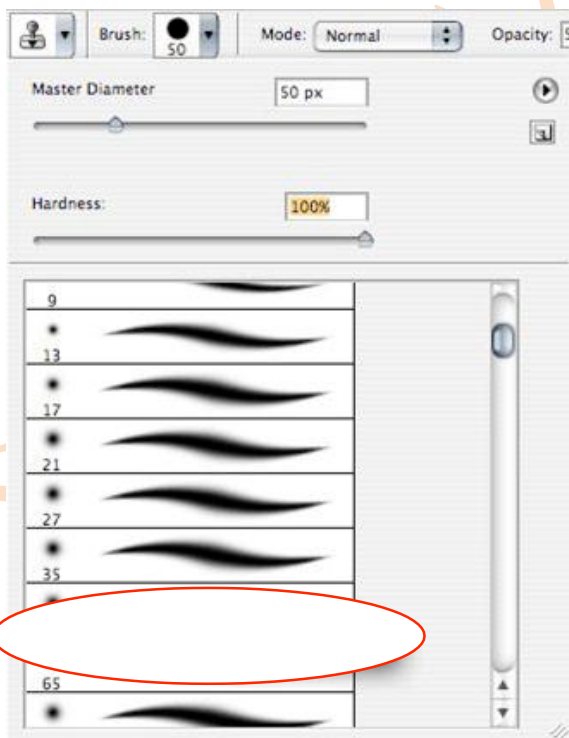


Figure 5. Brush settings

6. Hold down the **SHIFT** key and click in the clean area (without "hot spots") to get a sample of color (Figure 6).



Figure 6. Clone Stamp selection

7. Paint over the "hot spot", the light area will gradually darken (Figure 7).



Figure 7. Corrected image

ADDING FLASH

If you took pictures indoors without a flash they will turn out underexposed and dark; in Photoshop, you can make your photos lighter. To fix underexposed photos, follow these steps:

1. Open a digital photo you wish to correct (Figure 8).



Figure 8. Underexposed photo

2. In the main menu, go to **Layers > Duplicate**. In the **Duplicate Layer** dialog box, name the layer **Layer 1**.
3. Make sure **Layer 1** is selected in the **Layers** palette. In the **Blending Mode** dropdown box, change the **Blending Mode** to **Screen** (Figure 9). The whole image will lighten.

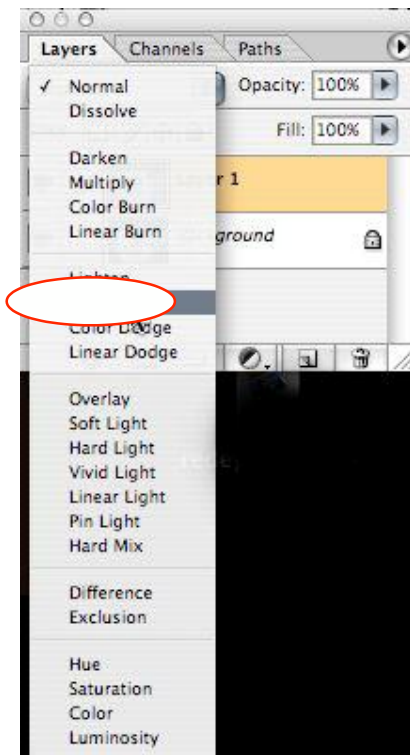


Figure 9. Changing the Blending Mode

4. Keep duplicating Layer 1 till you are satisfied with the quality of your image (Figure 10).



Figure 10. Corrected photo

COLOR ADJUSTMENT

Color adjustment options in Photoshop CS can help you to make your digital photos look more natural. To color correct your images, follow these steps:

1. Open the image you wish to correct.
2. In the main menu, go to **Image > Adjustments > Levels**. You will see a dialog box displaying a diagram of the colors in your image (Figure 11). The black triangle is for shadows, the gray is for midtones, the white is for highlights. In the **Channels** dropdown menu, you can choose between RGB, Red, Green, or Blue. These indicate whether your changes effect all the colors, or just one (red, green, or blue).

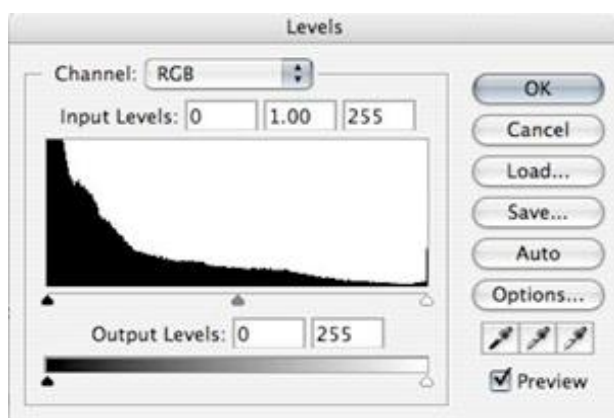


Figure 11. Levels dialog box

3. Make sure the **Preview** box is checked off. Choose the channel you wish to change and drag the triangles. Dragging the black triangle to the right will make the shadows in your photo darker; dragging the white triangle to the left will make the highlights in your photo lighter; dragging the gray triangle to the left will make the midtones in your photo lighter, dragging it to the right will make the midtones darker. You will be able to see the changes in your image (Figure 12 a and b). Selecting just one color channel can alter the color of your photo completely.



Figure 12 a. Initial image



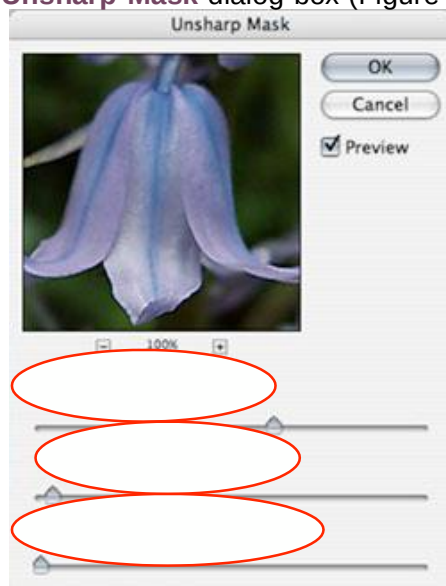
Figure 12 b. Corrected image

SHARPENING/SOFTENING

SHARPENING

If your digital **photos** are slightly out of focus, you can use the basic sharpening technique to make your images look crisper. To sharpen your photo, follow the steps below:

1. Open an image you wish to sharpen. Note that this technique can sharpen images that are only slightly blurry.
2. Use the **Zoom Tool** to make sure you are viewing your image in its full size, that is, at 100%.
3. In the main menu, go to **Filter> Sharpen> Unsharp Mask**. You will see the **Unsharp Mask** dialog box (Figure 1).



4. Figure 1. Unsharp Mask dialog box
5. Enter 125 for the **Amount**, 1 for the **Radius**, and 3 for the **Threshold**.
6. Click OK. You will see how the image has become more in focus.

SOFTENING

Sometimes you might not want objects or people in your photos look too sharp, in this case you can use a softening technique. To soften an image, follow these steps:

1. Open the image you wish to soften.
2. In the main menu, choose **Layer > Duplicate Layer**. You will have a new layer called **Background Copy**.
3. In the main menu, go to **Filter > Blur > Gaussian Blur**. In the **Gaussian Blur** dialog box, type in 4 for **Radius**, or drag the slider to this position (Figure 2).

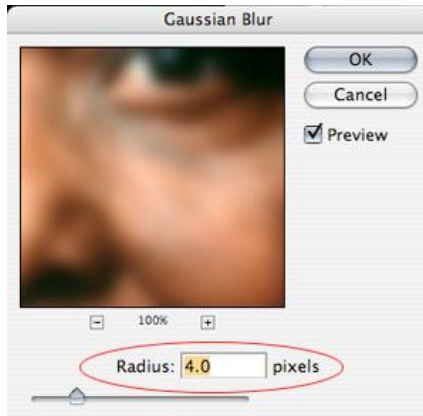


Figure 2. Gaussian Blur

4. Make sure the **Background Copy** layer is selected and change its opacity to 50% (Figure 3). The objects or people in your image will have a soft, glowing effect.

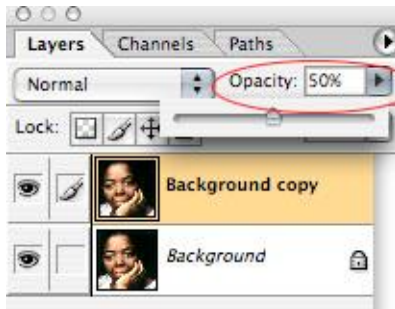


Figure 3. Opacity

5. Select the **Eraser Tool** from the **Toolbox**, choose a soft-edged brush, and erase over the areas in the face that are supposed to be sharp, such as eyes, eyebrows, lips, and teeth (Figure 4a and b).



Figure 4a. Before



Figure 4b. After

SAVING

Remember to save your work often. Saving frequently lessens the risk of losing the work you have been doing. To save your Photoshop document, do the following:

1. Click **File > Save**.
2. Navigate to the place you would like your document to be saved by using the dropdown menu and the navigation window.
3. Enter the name of your document in the **Save As** text field.
4. Choose a format to save your project in from the **Format** dropdown menu.
5. Click the **Save** button in the bottom right corner of the dialogue box.
6. Check to make sure that your document is saved in the place you intended.

NOTE: If you save your file as PSD (default Photoshop saving format) your layers will be preserved, but the file size will be large. If you save your file as JPEG (a common image format) your layers will be flattened and become one layer. The file size though will be significantly smaller.

Selecting an Area

Photoshop has multiple selection tools to accommodate the different types of selections. All of these tools are found in the Toolbox.

This document contains information on:

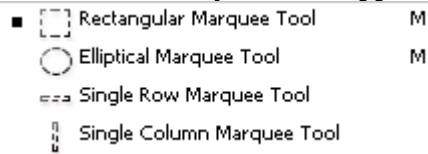
- Selecting with the Marquee Tools
- Selecting with the Lasso Tools
- Selecting with the Magic Wand Tool
- Saving a Selection
- Loading a Selection
- Deselecting an Area

Selecting with the Marquee Tools

Marquee tools make rectangular, elliptical, and single row or single column selections. The *Marquee* tools are found in the uppermost left corner of the *Toolbox*.

To recognize this tool, look for one of these buttons: 

1. From the *Toolbox*, select and hold the *Marquee Tool*
The hidden *Marquee* tools appear.



2. Select one of the tools
HINT: You can switch between the *Rectangular Marquee Tool* and the *Elliptical Marquee Tool* by pressing [Shift] + [M].
3. To select an area, click and drag the the crosshair pointer to surround your desired selection
HINTS:
To obtain a perfect square or circle, press and hold [**Shift**] before clicking and dragging the mouse.
4. To finish the selection, release the mouse button
NOTE: The selected area is now surrounded by animated dashes.
HINT: If your selection is not quite right, press [Ctrl] + [D] and repeat steps 2-4.
5. Complete the desired action (e.g., copy, add color)
NOTE: The area remains selected.
6. To prevent inadvertent changes to the selected area, when complete, deselect the area

Selecting with the Lasso Tools

Lasso tools make free hand selections of irregularly shaped areas, with or without straight edges. When working with these tools, the pointer takes the shape of the tool. To make the selection process more precise, you can convert it to a crosshair pointer by pressing

[**Caps Lock**].

HINT: You can switch between the *Lasso* tools by pressing [**Shift**] + [L].

Making Free Hand Selections

Selecting with the *Lasso Tool* is similar to drawing a line around an area with a pen.

NOTE: The method used is click and drag. When you release the mouse button, the selection is completed.

1. From the *Toolbox*, select **Lasso Tool** .
2. Click and drag around the contours/border of the area you want to select
3. Release the mouse button
the point at which you release will be connected with the beginning point to enclose the area.
NOTE: The selected area is now surrounded by animated dashes.
HINT: If your selection is not quite right, press [**Ctrl**] + [**D**] and repeat steps 2-3.
4. Complete the desired action (e.g., copy, add color)
The area remains selected.
5. To prevent inadvertent changes to the selected area, when complete, deselect the area

Making Straight-Edged Selections

The *Polygonal Lasso Tool* allows you to select oddly shaped areas of an image. You can use this tool if you want to select a triangular or other polygonal area of an image.

1. From the *Toolbox*, select the **Polygonal Lasso Tool** .
- NOTE: The *Polygonal Lasso Tool* is a hidden lasso tool. Click and hold the *Lasso Tool*  button on the *Toolbox* to select the *Lasso* tool of your choice, e.g., the *Polygonal Lasso Tool*.
2. Position the polygonal lasso pointer where you want to start selecting and click the mouse
3. Move to the next corner of the area you want to select and click
HINT: To ensure a straight line selection, press [**Shift**] before clicking.
A line and an anchor point appear.
4. Repeat step 3 until the desired area is selected
5. To finish the selection, double click on the last point
OR
Move the pointer to the starting point of the selection and click
NOTE: The last point you double clicked will connect to the first point you created.
HINT: If your selection is not quite right, press [**Ctrl**] + [**D**] and repeat steps 2-5.
The selected area is now surrounded by animated dashes.
6. Complete the desired action (e.g., copy, add color)
The area remains selected.

7. To prevent inadvertent changes to the selected area, when complete, deselect the area

Making Irregularly-Shaped Selections

The *Magnetic Lasso Tool* allows you to select particular objects out of your image without having to free hand it. The *Magnetic Lasso* works by detecting differences in color pixels between the area that is being selected and what surrounds it. Therefore, it works best when the color difference is significant. The *Magnetic Lasso Tool* works less well if the object being selected is similar in color to its background.

1. From the *Toolbox*, select the ***Magnetic Lasso Tool***.
NOTE: The *Magnetic Lasso Tool* is a hidden lasso tool. Click and hold the *Lasso Tool* button on the *Toolbox* to select the *Lasso* tool of your choice, e.g., the *Magnetic Lasso Tool*.
2. Position the lasso pointer where you want to start selecting and click to set the first *Fastening Point*.
HINT: If the pointer is not in the form of a magnetic lasso, press [**Caps Lock**].
NOTE: *Fastening Points* anchor your selection border in place.



3. Move the mouse along the edge of the area you want to select. It automatically draws a moveable line that "clings" to areas of similar color between *Fastening Points*.
4. To add a straight-edge selection,
 - a. Release the mouse button
 - b. Press [**Alt**] + click at the starting point of the straight-edge selection. This sets the *Fastening Point* for the start.
 - c. Release [**Alt**] and the mouse button
 - d. Move the mouse to the endpoint of the straight-edge
 - e. Click the mouse button. This sets the *Fastening Point* at the end of the straight-edge selection. Your

cursor returns to the *Magnetic Lasso* and you can resume free hand selection.

5. If the border does not automatically snap to the desired edge, click the mouse button once to add a *Fastening Point* manually
6. To erase recently drawn segments and *Fastening Points*, press [**Delete**]
7. To finish the selection, double click on the last point

OR

Move the pointer to the starting point of the selection and click

NOTE: The last point you double clicked will connect to the first point you created.

HINT: If your selection is not quite right, press [**Ctrl**] + [**D**] and repeat steps 2-6.

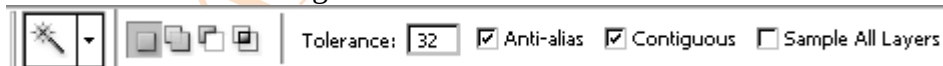
8. Complete the desired action (e.g., copy or add color)
9. To prevent inadvertent changes to the selected area, when complete, deselect the area

Selecting with the Magic Wand Tool

The *Magic Wand Tool* selects areas of similar color. To increase or decrease the range of color selected, you can adjust the *Tolerance*, or color range, of the *Magic Wand Tool*.

To select an area:

1. From the *Toolbox*, select the ***Magic Wand Tool*** 
HINT: If the *Magic Wand Tool* is not visible, you may need to click and hold on the *Quick Selection Tool* to find it.
2. From the *Objects* toolbar, in the *Tolerance* text box, specify a value
NOTE: Low levels of *Tolerance* result in a smaller selection area. High levels of *Tolerance* result in a larger selection area.



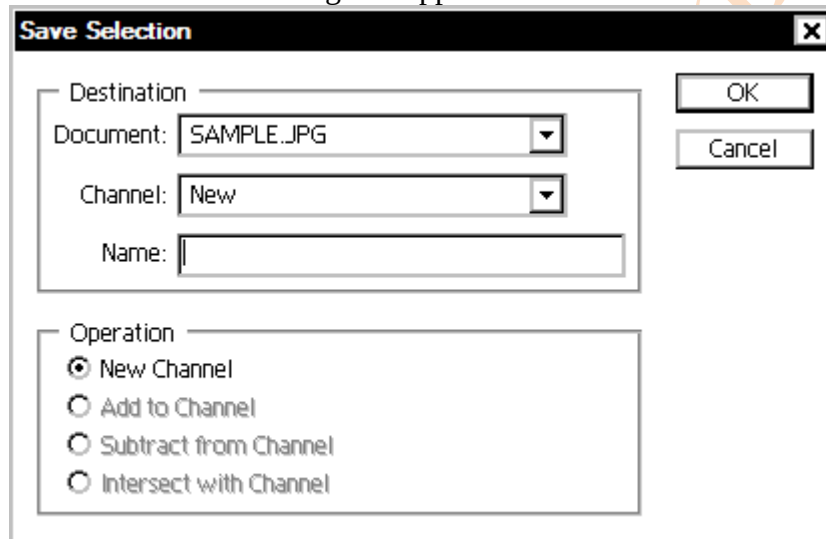
3. To select only like-colored pixels that are next to each other, select ***Contiguous***
OR
To select all like-colored pixels in the image, de-select ***Contiguous***
4. In your image, click a spot within the area that you want to select
Similar colors around the area where you clicked are selected.
5. OPTIONAL: Enlarge or reduce the selected area:
NOTE: These selections are also based on similar colors and may result in unintentional additions or subtractions.
 - a. To add to the selected area, press [**Shift**] while clicking areas not included in the original selection
 - b. To subtract from the selected area, press [**Alt**] while clicking areas you want to exclude
6. Complete the desired action (e.g., copy, add color)
The area remains selected.

7. To prevent inadvertent changes to the selected area, when complete, deselect the area

Saving a Selection

Focusing on a particular area of an image is done using the selection tools; however, many times you need to work with different areas at different times. Photoshop allows you to save selection areas to make re-selecting these areas more efficient.

1. Select the desired area
2. From the *Select* menu, select **Save Selection...**
The *Save Selection* dialog box appears.



3. In the *Name* text box, type a name for the selection
NOTE: A *Channel* is how Photoshop saves the selection information. You can view your saved channels by clicking on the *Channels* tab next to the *Layers* tab in the Layers palette.
4. Click **OK**

Loading a Selection

In order to work with a saved selection, it needs to be loaded.

1. From the *Select* menu, select **Load Selection...**
The *Load Selection* dialog box appears.
2. From the *Channel* pull-down list, choose the desired selection

3. Click **OK**
the selection is loaded.

Deselecting an Area

To prevent inadvertent changes to a selected area, you should deselect it.

1. From the *Select* menu, select **Deselect**
OR
Press [**Ctrl**] + [**D**]

Components of a Color Management System

Color Management System (CMS).

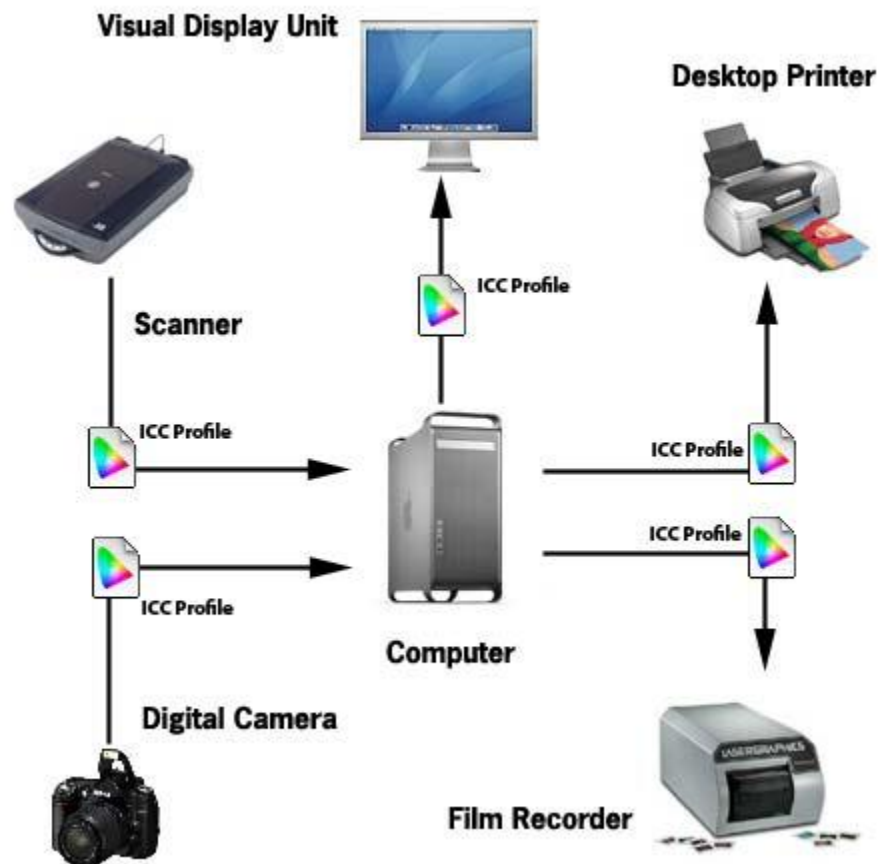
A color managed system comprises three basic components, namely: -

1. **A device-independent color space** - this is usually referred to as the Working or Reference color space.
2. **ICC profiles** for each device (i.e. printer, scanner, monitor, digital camera, etc.) that will accurately describe the unique color characteristics of each device.
3. **A Color Matching Module (CMM)** that will interpret the information contained within the device profiles and carry out the instructions on how the color characteristics of each device should be treated.

Color Numbers, their Meaning and ICC Profiles

A digital image will usually comprise many millions pixels, each of which is represented by a numeric value. The value assigned to each pixel will describe many attributes but in this essay it's the color value or mix (e.g. RGB value) that we're most interested in. The role of ICC profiles is to ensure that discrepancies that result from the widely differing color characteristics of each device are known to the color management system. Device profiles come in two basic forms, i.e. Input and Output. Input profiles typically describe the color characteristics of scanners and digital cameras, whereas Output profiles describe devices such as monitors, printers and film recorders. Input profiles are often referred to as one-way since they represent the source device.

The following flow diagram demonstrates a typical imaging workflow, with the document being passed between devices: - from scanner/digital camera - to - computer - to - monitor - and printer.



Typical Imaging System

Document Specific Color

Just like its more recent predecessors Photoshop CS continues to use document specific color settings. Actually, the Working Space that's chosen in the Color Settings dialog has a direct bearing on only three types of document, viz.: -

1. The default color space of new documents created via the New command found in the File menu
2. Existing documents without an embedded ICC profile
3. Imported documents with no embedded ICC profile (i.e. untagged documents), which might include scanned documents or those emanating from digital cameras.

Monitor Calibration and Characterization

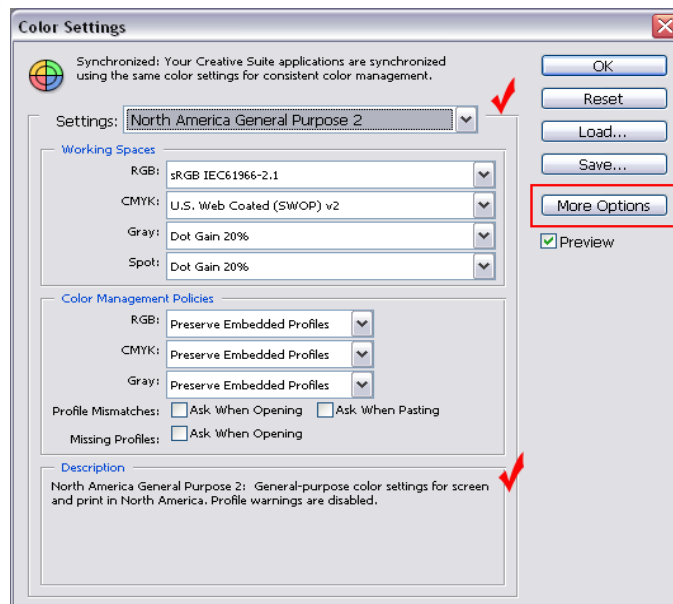
Monitor calibration and characterization (profiling) is probably the most important aspect of a color managed workflow; yet many users seem oblivious to issues poor monitor calibration, etc can have on their documents. So, what is calibration, why is it so important, and why is it different from characterization? Calibration is a process whereby a device is brought to a standard state (e.g. a color temperature of 6500K and gamma of 2.2), whereas characterizing the monitor is the process of determining how the monitor represents or reproduces color. We characterize the monitor by measuring how it displays known color values, then creating an ICC profile. The ICC profile is simply a data file that includes a description of the monitors color handling characteristics (i.e. its gamut). The calibration data will also be written into the ICC profile. As I've already mentioned, Photoshop then uses the monitor profile to automatically optimize the display of documents. It does so by carrying out an on-the-fly conversion between your document profile (e.g. ProPhoto RGB, Adobe RGB, sRGB, Color Match) and your monitor profile. This conversion does not alter the actual document in any way; just its appearance on the monitor.

Profile locations:-

1. Windows XP and Vista - sub-folder named Windows\system32\spool\drivers\color
2. Mac OSX - ColorSync profiles are generally located in either the Library/ColorSync/Profiles or Users/~/Library/ColorSync/Profiles folder

Photoshop CS3 Color Settings

The **Color Settings** dialog is the control room for the Photoshop color management system, and like all control rooms it can appear complicated. Opening the **Color Settings**, which is found towards the bottom of the **Edit** menu?

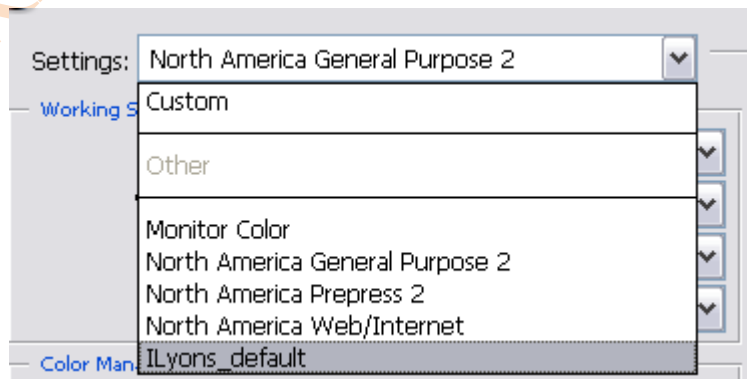


The first thing that I will draw your attention to is the box at the bottom of the dialog labeled **Description**. As the mouse is moved across the various pop-up menus, etc. you should see a short but informative explanation of what each menu does. Also note the button labeled **More Options**; it's probably best that you select it now, as it will let you see the complete **Color Settings** dialog rather than the simplified version.

The default RGB color setting depends upon your location but generally you'll find that it's either: **North America General Purpose 2** or **Europe General Purpose 2**. If you're working with documents that are primarily destined for the web then either is perfectly acceptable. However, if your documents are destined for print then these settings are generally regarded as being less than ideal. So, if the **General Purpose 2** settings are not ideal, what is?

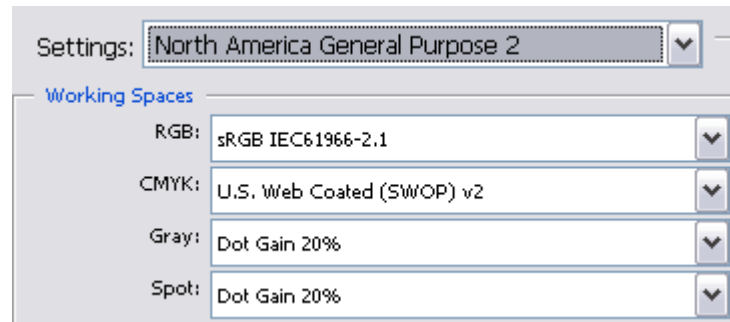
I could answer the above question by simply writing "**US or Europe Prepress Defaults**", but doing so doesn't really help explain why nor would it be strictly true. Therefore, I will work my way through each section of the **Color Settings** dialog in turn.

The first section is labeled **Settings**, and is a simple pop-up menu with a list of preset Photoshop settings plus any that you may have saved previously. You needn't worry too much about this section just yet.



Working Spaces

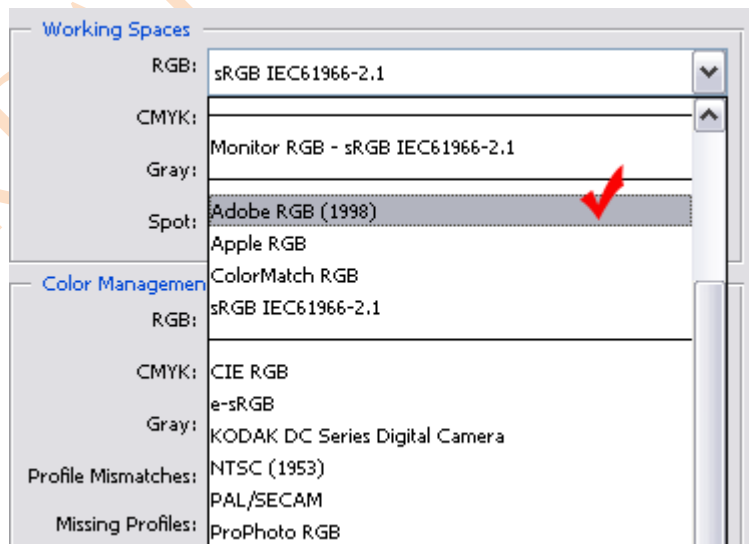
The next section is labeled Working Spaces, and as I discussed earlier the selections made here will determine the Working Space profiles used for color handling of your documents.



There are four **Working Space** types in Photoshop: **RGB**, **CMYK**, **Gray** and **Spot** (occasionally called Modes because they appear under the Image>Mode menu). Since configuring the others follows a similar process I will concentrate on the **RGB Working Space**.

RGB - Working Space

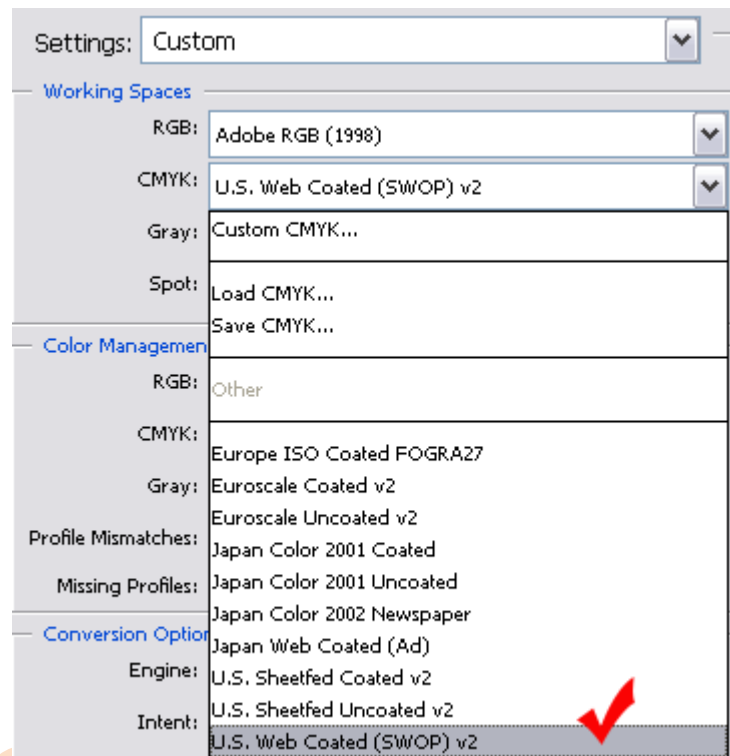
Clicking the **RGB** pop-up menu with the mouse will produce a list of options similar to that shown below.



CMYK - Working Space

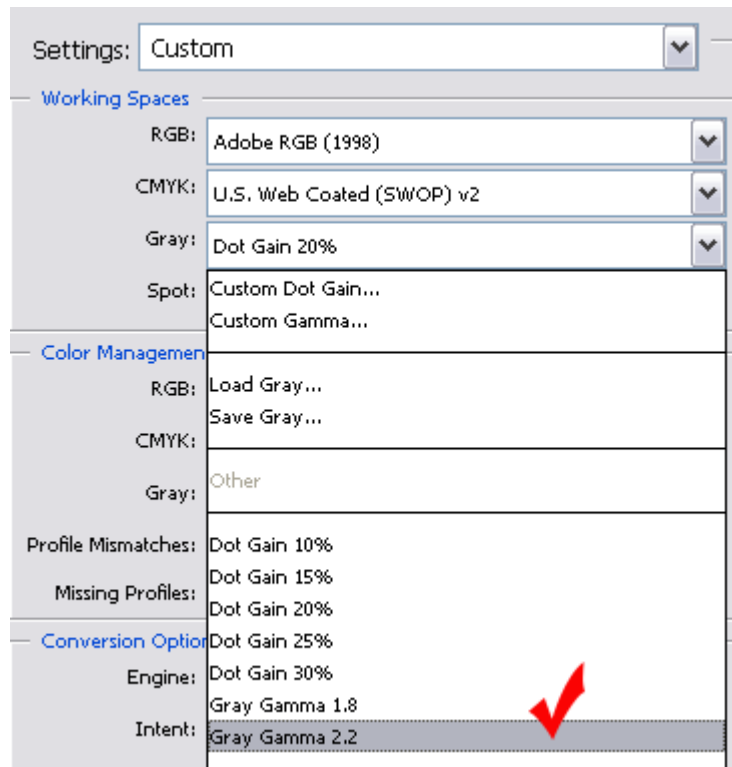
Desktop type inkjet printers from Epson, Canon and HP actually require RGB data rather than CMYK, which means that the choice you make for this particular Working Space will have no influence in their actual output. This is the main reason that I leave it set at the default US Web Coated (SWOP) v2, and if using a desktop inkjet, then I suggest that you do likewise.

So, other than the list of available profiles, the procedure for choosing CMYK Working Space isn't that different to RGB. Again, having More Options activated gives you a more extensive list.



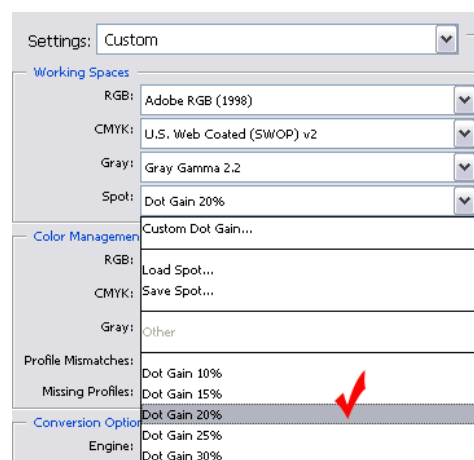
Gray scale - Working Space

With the Gray scale Working Space we have access to two gamma settings, a series of five preset dot gain curves, the ColorSync Gray Work Space (Mac only) and the ability to customize the dot gain to our own requirements. The Gray Gamma 2.2 is probably the best for most users, but feels free to experiment.



Spot - Working Space

The **Spot** pop-up menu is broadly similar to the grayscale, but for spot colors. The options that we find include a series of five preset **Dot Gain** options and the facility for customizing the **Dot Gain** curve if required. The screenshot shown below indicates that I've selected **20% Dot Gain** version as my default.

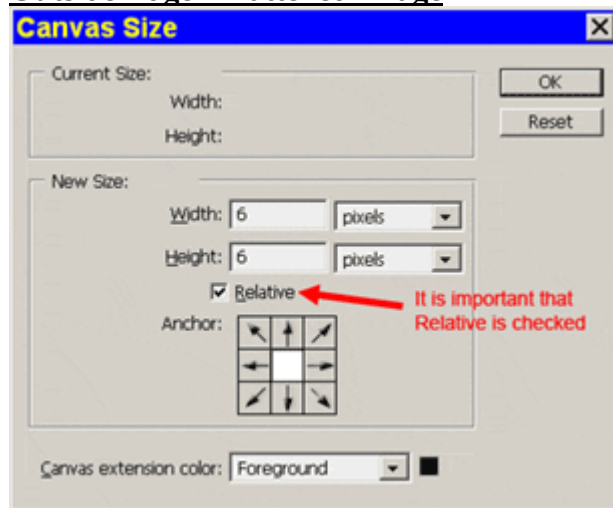


Enhancing Image

Print Strokes on an Image

Basically, there are two methods of creating an edge. The first is to slightly increase the size of the document and then add the edge so that it does not overlay image pixels. This will be referred to as an outside edge. The second, and most common, is to add an edge that overlays the image's pixels. This will be referred to as an inside edge.

Outside Edge - Flattened Image



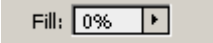
In this technique, the document size is increased by the size of the stroke. The stroke is added to the image layer without overlaying any image pixels. In this example, we will use a 3 pixel wide stroke. The Background layer should remain locked.

1. Set the foreground color  in the Tools panel to the color you want the stroke to be.
2. Click Image > Canvas Size.
3. Change Width to 6 and the unit of measure to pixels. This will add 3 pixels to both the left and right sides of the image.
4. Change Height to 6 and the unit of measure to pixels. This will add 3 pixels to both the top and bottom of the image.
5. Click the Relative check box so that it is checked. See Figure 1.
6. Leave Anchor such that the image is centered both horizontally and vertically.
7. Make sure Canvas extension color is Foreground. If this option is disabled, there is no default Background layer. To create a Background layer, make the bottommost layer the active layer and then click Layer > New > Background From Layer.
8. Click OK. The file's dimensions will be increased and the new area will be filled by the color identified as the canvas extension color.

Outside Edge - Layered Image

In this technique, the document size is increased by the size of the stroke. It differs from the previous technique in that the stroke is added above any adjustment layers to prevent the stroke from being affected by the adjustment layers. In this example, we will use a 3 pixel wide stroke. The Background layer will need to be unlocked.

1. In the Layer's panel, double click the Background layer.
2. In the New Layer dialog box, type a name and then click OK. This unlocks the Background layer.
3. Click Image > Canvas Size.
4. Change Width to 6 and the unit of measure to pixels. This will add 3 pixels to both the left and right sides of the image. We can use whatever size we want, but it has to be an even number.
5. Change Height to 6 and the unit of measure to pixels. This will add 3 pixels to both the top and bottom of the image. Make sure size for height is the same as used for width.
6. Click the Relative check box so that it is checked. See Figure 1.
7. Leave Anchor such that the image is centered both horizontally and vertically.
8. Canvas extension color should be grayed out.
9. Click OK. The file's dimensions will be increased and the new area will be transparent.
10. Create a new layer by clicking Layer > New > Layer. Or, by clicking the Create a new layer icon  on the bottom of the Layers panel. Name it something meaningful, such as Edge.
11. Make sure it is the top most layer. If it is not, click and drag it till it is the top most layer.
12. Using the paint bucket tool  and white as the foreground color , fill the layer with white paint. Do not be concerned when the image becomes concealed by white.
13. Add a stroke by clicking Layer > Layer Style > Stroke. Or, click the Add a layer style icon  at the bottom of the Layers panel and select Stroke.
14. Set Size to the desired size. In this example, use 3 pixels. The size should be exactly half the size used in steps 4 and 5.
15. Change Position to Inside. Even though we are using Inside, the stroke will actually be on the outside of the image because we increased the canvas size in the previous steps.
16. Make sure Blending Mode is Normal.
17. Make sure Opacity is 100%.
18. Make sure Fill Type is Color.
19. Click once on the Color box to set the color of the edge. Black is RGB values 0, 0, 0.
20. Click OK to close the Color Picker dialog box.
21. Click OK to close the Layer Style dialog box. This will create the stroke.

22. In the Layers panel, set the edge layer's Fill value to 0%.  Do not change Opacity, leave it 100% or the edge will be affected. The layer's blending mode should be left to Normal.

Inside Edge - Flattened Image

This technique will add an edge without having to change the size of the image. The stroke is added to the image layer. The stroke will overlay image pixels. The Background layer will need to be unlocked.

1. In the Layer's panel, double click the Background layer.
2. In the New Layer dialog box, type a name and then click OK.
3. Add a stroke by clicking Layer > Layer Style > Stroke. Or, click the Add a layer style icon  at the bottom of the Layers panel and select Stroke.
4. Set Size to the desired size. Try 2 or 3 pixels to start with.
5. Change Position to Inside.
6. Make sure Blending Mode is Normal.
7. Make sure Opacity is 100%.
8. Make sure Fill Type is Color.
9. Click once on the Color box to set the color of the edge. Black is RGB values 0, 0, 0.
10. Click OK to close the Color Picker dialog box.
11. Click OK to close the Layer Style dialog box. This will create the stroke.
12. If desired, click Layer > Flatten Image to re-flatten the image.

Inside Edge - Layered Image

This technique will add an edge without having to change the size of the image. The image does not have to have a locked Background layer. This technique adds the stroke above any adjustment layers to prevent the stroke from being affected by the adjustment layers.

1. Create a new layer by clicking Layer > New > Layer. Or, by clicking the Create a new layer icon  on the bottom of the Layers panel. Name it something meaningful, such as Edge.
2. Make sure it is the top most layer. If it is not, click and drag it till it is the top most layers.
3. Using the paint bucket tool  and white as the foreground color , fill the layer with white paint. Do not be concerned when the image becomes concealed by white.
4. Add a stroke by clicking Layer > Layer Style > Stroke. Or, click the Add a layer style icon  at the bottom of the Layers panel and select Stroke.
5. Set Size to the desired size. Try 2 or 3 pixels to start with.
6. Change Position to Inside.
7. Make sure Blending Mode is Normal.
8. Make sure Opacity is 100%.
9. Make sure Fill Type is Color.
10. Click once on the Color box to set the color of the edge. Black is RGB values 0, 0, 0.
11. Click OK to close the Color Picker dialog box.

12. Click OK to close the Layer Style dialog box. This will create the stroke.

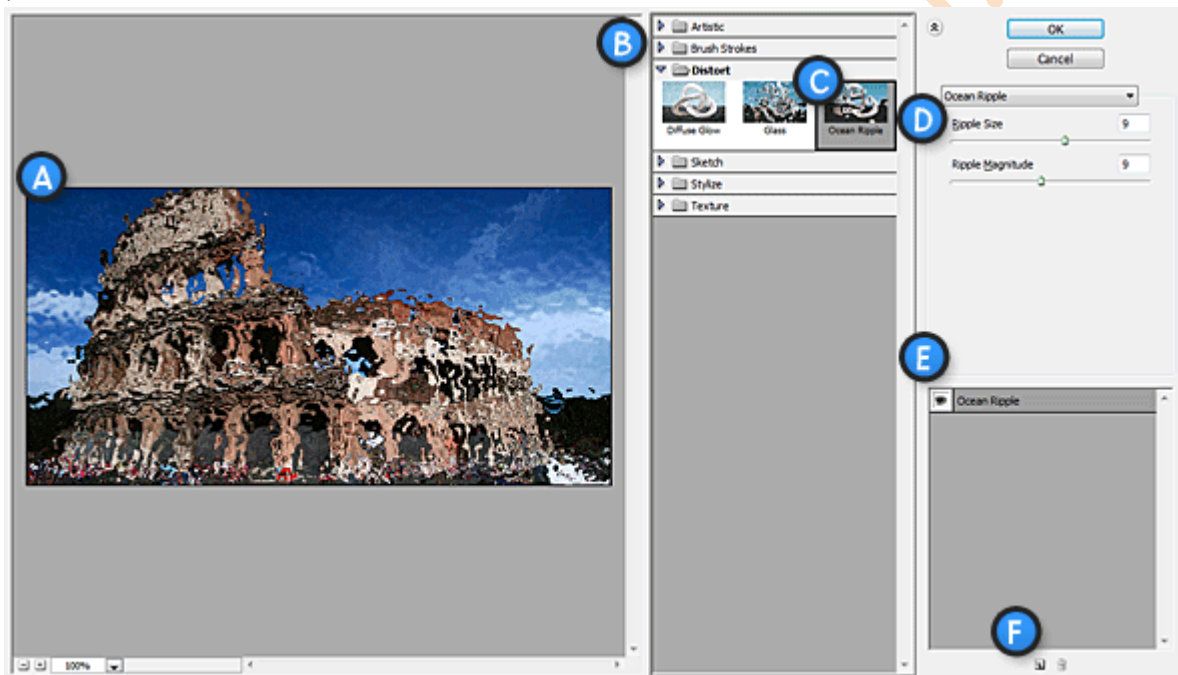
Apply Filter Effects

Filters are used to change the appearance of an image, layer or selection in Photoshop.

Using Filters from the Filter Gallery

Photoshop's Filter Gallery is basically a one-stop place for working with filters in your documents. In the **Filter Gallery**, you can browse through many different types of filters, apply them individually to your image, or even stack them on top of one another like you would with layers. You can get to the Filter Gallery by going to **Filter > Filter Gallery**.

:



Filter Gallery Interface

A. Filter Preview

B. Filter List (Note: You can show or hide this list by clicking the arrow icon to the top right of it)

C. Currently Selected Filter

D. Filter Options

E. Effect Layers

F. New / Delete Effect Layer

The Filter Effect Layers work just like ordinary filters in Photoshop, and can be dragged and dropped on top of one another for desired results.

Applying a filter from the gallery is very easy to do. Simply click on a filter, adjust its options to your liking, and click OK to apply. To stack multiple filters on top of one

another, just hit the New Effect Layer ('F' in diagram above), and select another filter. You can expand filter types by clicking the folders in the filter list.



Quicker Access to Filters

The Filter Gallery is really just a browser of sorts. If you know exactly what kind of filter you want to use, you can access it directly from the Filter menu in Photoshop to speed things up.

Using Other Filters

Not all filters in Photoshop are available through the Filter Gallery. Many of them must be accessed directly through the Filter Menu, and have unique interfaces and options of their own.

We're not going to go over every individual filter in this tutorial (doing so would take a very long time), but I highly suggest doing some experimentation on your part with different filters to get an idea of what some of them do.

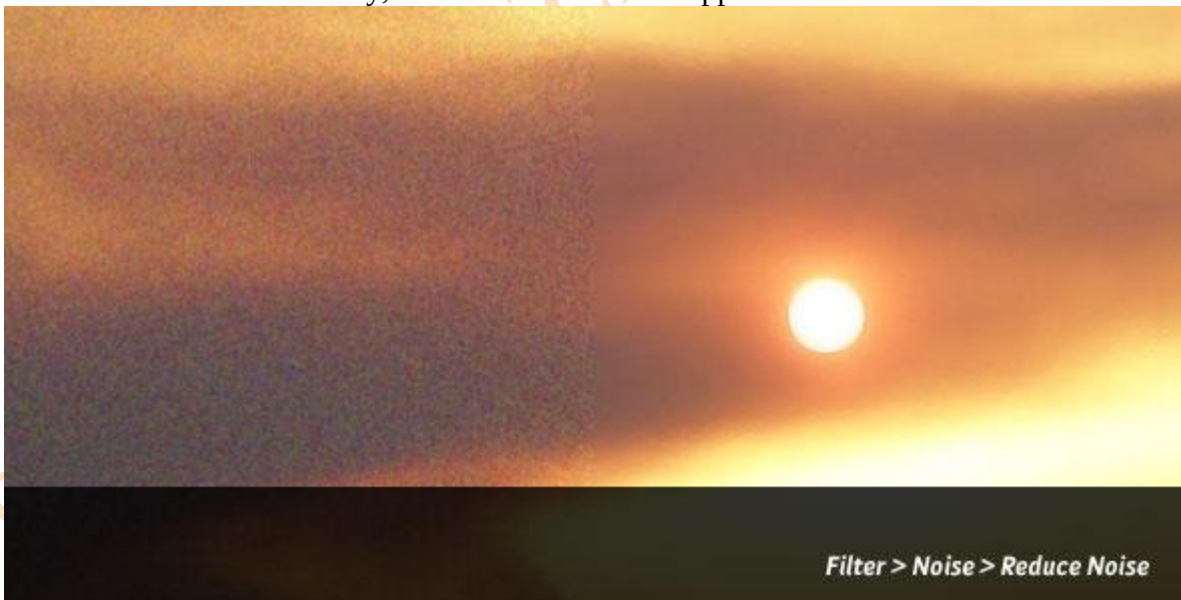
Blur Filters (Filter > Blur)

The Blur Filters are useful in lots of situations. We've actually written several popular tutorials on Tutorial9 that depend on the Blur Filters, such as our article on Adding Depth of Field in Photoshop, and our Windows Vista Aurora Effect Tutorial.



Noise Filters (Filter > Noise)

Noise Filters are great for adding, or reducing noise and grain in photographs. You may find filters such as the Reduce Noise Filter extremely useful if you work with old, damaged, or dusty photographs that need repair work done to them. The Add Noise Filter can also come in handy, and has some creative applications of its own.



Sharpen Filters (Filter > Sharpen)

The Sharpen Filters are also great for correcting imperfections in photographs, as well as putting emphasis on important elements in a design. When working with blurred images, a

sharpen filter can be used to clarify and better define edges by increasing contrast between pixels.



Convert an Image to Black and White

There must be as many ways of converting a RGB image to black and white as there are photographers. There are entire web sites devoted to the many ways of doing this. Many of these sources show us a technique to convert a RGB image to black and white and then state 'move the sliders around until you see something you like'. While is it correct that the final image is more important than the original image.

INTRODUCTION TO CUSTOMARY METHODS

There are five methods discussed here.

- Convert to true gray scale
- Desaturation
- Red, Green or Blue Channel
- Channel Mixer
- Convert to Lab

CHANNEL MIXER

The purpose of the Channel Mixer adjustment layer is to allow us to control the mix of each color channel to determine the resulting colors and tones in the image. Specifically, for a RGB image, it allows us to mix the various amounts of Red, Green and Blue.



The basic way to use this method is to first look at the red, green and blue channels individually on the Channels panel. Find the one that looks closest to the desired results. Reactive all channels, switch back to the Layers panel and create a Channel Mixer adjustment layer. When we first open the Channel Mixer dialog box, it defaults to Red at 100%, Green and 0% and Blue at 0% and the monochrome box is unchecked.

The advantage of this method is we have control over the tones as we change the percentages. The disadvantage is the balancing act that needs to be performed to keep the total near 100%.

DESATURATION

There are two ways to desaturate an image.

The first is **Image > Adjustments > Desaturate**.

The second is to create a Hue/Saturation adjustment layer on top of the image with Saturation set to -100. Since only the second method is non-destructive, it is the only method that will be discussed here.

The advantages of the desaturation method using an adjustment layer are that it is non-destructive, intuitive and easy to do. It is non-destructive because the RGB image retains all of its color information.

GRAYSCALE

In this method, we simply click

Image > Mode > Gray scale

In Adobe Photoshop and our image is converted to black and white. The advantages of this method are that it is quick, intuitive and retains perceived luminance.

LAB color

In this method, click

Image > Mode > Lab Color.

Photoshop will convert the image to the Lab color space. Go to the Channels panel and turn off the a and b channels. The a and b channels are the color channels. This should leave only the Lightness channel active. The Lightness channel is the luminance channel. Switch back to the Layers panel and we have our black and white image.

RGB CHANNEL

This method is one of the easiest and is non-destructive. We simply look at the red, green and blue channels individually on the Channels panel. Find the one that we like the most and leave that channel as the only active channel and we are done.

BLACK AND WHITE TONING

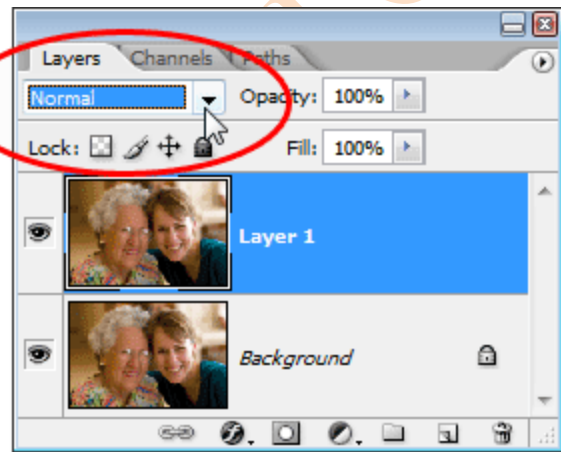
The toning of black and white images is not mandatory. In black and white film photography, it was done for several reasons. To increase the archival quality of a print. To intensify contrast. To neutralize undesired color casts inherit in some photographic papers. Or, to give an image a specific color cast.

Blend Layers

Layer blend modes give us different ways for a layer to interact with, or "blend" with, the layer or layers below it. Without layer blend modes, the only real way we have of blending layers together is by reducing the opacity (or fill) of a layer, which usually doesn't give us very interesting results. But with blend modes, not only do they unlock a world of creative possibilities, especially when we combine them with layer masks, they can also be extremely helpful when it comes to editing, retouching and restoring photos.

Find the Layer Blend Modes

You can access all of the blend modes from a drop-down list in the top left corner of the Layers palette. By default, the "Normal" blend mode is selected:



The Layer Blend Modes drop-down box in the top left corner of the Layers palette.

One important thing to note here is that if you look at the screenshot above, you'll notice that I've gone ahead and made a copy of the original Background layer (by pressing Ctrl+J and that I currently have the copy, named "Layer 1", selected. That's because Photoshop treats the Background layer differently from all other layers and it doesn't allow us to change the blend mode for the Background layer.



As we can see in the CCFC (Color Coded For Convenience - yes, I just made that up) diagram above, the "Darken", "Multiply", "Color Burn", and "Linear Burn" blend modes are the **Darken** modes. Why? Because each one of them has the effect of making the image darker. Notice that the **multiply** blend mode is included in the Darken group. If you remember, it's one of the five blend modes you absolutely need to know and one of the modes we'll be taking a closer look at in a moment.

Next, the "Lighten", "Screen", "Color Dodge", and "Linear Dodge" modes make up the **Lighten** group. Each one of them has the effect of lightening the image. Notice that the **Screen** blend mode is included in the Lighten group, another one you need to know and one of the ones we'll be looking at.

Below that, the "Overlay", "Soft Light", "Hard Light", "Vivid Light", "Linear Light", "Pin Light", and "Hard Mix" modes make up the **Contrast** group. Each one both darkens *and* lightens the image, boosting contrast. Notice that the **Overlay** mode, another one you need to know and one we'll be looking at, is part of the Contrast group.

Next up is a group we're not going to be looking at in this discussion, the **Comparative** group, made up of the "Difference" and "Exclusion" blend modes. Both

of these modes are for comparing pixels between layers and neither one of them is used very often, especially in photo editing. Very rarely would you have a use for the "Difference" mode, and you'll use "Exclusion" almost as much as you use "Dissolve", which is to say pretty much never.

Finally, we have the **Composite** group, also known as the **HSL** group, which stands for "Hue, Saturation and Luminosity", which just happen to be the names of three of the four blend modes included in this final group, along with the "Color" mode. The blend modes in this group all have something to do with either the color or luminosity (lightness) values in the layer, and the **Color** and **Luminosity** modes make up the last of the five essential blend modes you need to know when it comes to editing photos and images in Photoshop.

Merge Layers and flatten image

Merge layers allows us to reduce the size of our files. However, it should be done with care because once a file is saved and closed, merging cannot be undone. Generally, layers in the master image file are seldom merged. When the master file is duplicated to make a print file, then layers are usually merged.

The merge layer commands are described below. They are located under Layer on the Photoshop menu. However, not all of the commands will be visible at the same time. Which options are available depends on the layers in the Layers panel. When merging layers, the resulting layer is an image layer.

Merge Layers	Combines two or more selected layers that are visible. Since this feature requires multiple layers to be selected, this choice first became available with CS2.
Merge Visible	Combines all visible layers. The resulting layer is the one that was active at the time of the merge.
Merge Linked	Combines all layers linked to the active layer, to the active layer. This option is available only in pre-CS2 versions. To replicate it in CS2, select Layer > Select Linked Layers and then select Layer > Merge Layers.
Merge Down	Combines the active layer with the layer immediately beneath it. Both layers have to be visible and only two layers are combined, regardless of how many other layers are visible.
Merge Layer	Combines all the layers in a layer set/group. The layer set/group has to

Set/Merge Group	be the active layer.
Merge Clipping Mask	Combines all the layers in a clipped group into a single layer. The bottom layer the other layers are clipped to has to be the active layer.
Flatten Image	Combines all visible layers and deletes all hidden layers. The resulting layer is a locked Background layer. Any transparent pixels are converted to white since the Background layer cannot have transparent pixels.

Convert Color Images to Gray scale

In Adobe Photoshop, we can quickly convert a RGB image to true gray scale by clicking **Image > Mode > Grayscale**

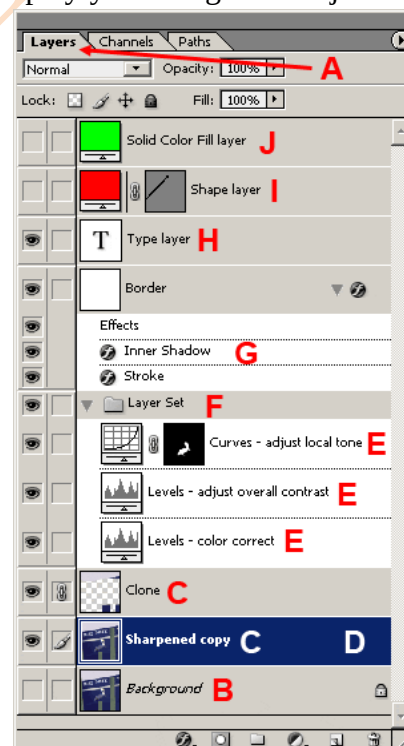
And the image is converted to black and white. However, this method is destructive and does not allow us to manage tone by color. The methods I devised and discuss here overcome these disadvantages while maintaining gray scale as the desired tonality.

Working with Layers

What is a layer? It is a concept used to organize and display your image and adjustments. The most fundamental layers are those that contain either pixels or an adjustment that alters the appearance of pixels.

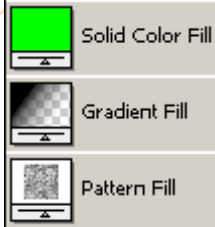
Layers are arranged vertically in an area of Photoshop called the Layers panel (all of Figure 1). When you look at your image in the Photoshop document window, you are looking at it through the layers in the Layers panel. As Photoshop processes the layers in the Layers panel, it begins with the bottommost layer and works its way upwards. This means the bottommost layer is altered by the layer above it. And the resulting image is further altered by the next layer up, and so forth. Therefore, the order in which layers appear is as important as the layers themselves.

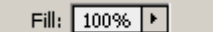
There are seven basic kinds of layers: Image, Adjustment, Fill, Type, Shape, Sets (called Groups since CS2) and Effects. In digital photography, the ones you will use the most are Image, Adjustment, Sets/Groups and possibly Effects.



Types of Layers

Layers Panel	A	The Layers panel is the working platform of your image. It is where all layers are arranged and stored.
Background Layer	B	The Background layer is the Photoshop default image layer. It is always a locked layer. To unlock it, double click the layer, type a new name and click OK. This also converts it into a normal image layer. In a RGB, CMYK or Grayscale image, the Background layer cannot have transparent pixels. The Background layer has to be converted to a normal layer to have transparent pixels.
Image Layer	C	Image layers are pixel containing layers. These are the layers that contain your image pixels. The Background layer is an image layer.
Active Layer	D	The active layer is the layer that is highlighted. Whatever actions you perform will be applied to the active layer. A layer does not have to be visible to be active. Since CS2, multiple layers can be active at a time. However, there are restrictions as to what actions can be performed when multiple layers are active.
Adjustment Layer	E	Adjustment layers are pixel altering layers. Adjustment layers apply an effect to the pixel containing layers beneath them. Adjustment layers only affect the layers beneath them, not above them. There are many types of adjustment layers. The adjustment layers commonly used in digital photography are listed on the Photoshop Topics page. If you turn off the visibility of all layers except the adjustment layers, you will see nothing but a transparent document. This is because adjustment layers do not contain image pixels.
Layer Sets/Groups	F	Layer sets/groups are a great way of grouping and organizing layers. Think of a layer set/group as a folder where other layers are stored. Layer sets is the pre-CS2 term. Adobe changed the term to layer groups in CS2. You can make certain changes to all the layers in a layer set/group by clicking on the layer set/group row and then applying the change; such as using the Move tool , or changing the opacity.

		A layer set/group can have a layer mask. The mask is applied to all layers in the layer set/group. By clicking the triangle to the left of the layer set/group folder icon, you expand ▼ or collapse ► a layer set/group. You can have layer sets/groups within layer sets/groups.
Effects	G	Effects are special effects that are applied to the contents of the layer they are linked to. An example of an effect is drop shadow. You can have more than one effect applied to a single layer. The effects linked to a layer become part of the layer's style. To delete layer effects, either right click the layer and select Clear Layer Style, or drag the effect (not the layer) to the delete layer icon 🗑️. Clearing the layer style will delete all effects, reset the blending mode to Normal, reset Opacity to 100% and reset Fill to 100%. Dragging the effect to the delete layer icon only deletes that one effect.
Type Layer	H	A Type layer is a layer that contains text.
Shape Layer	I	Shape layers contain shapes and lines. Technically, a Shape layer is a Solid Color Fill layer with a vector mask. It is the vector mask applied to the color fill that causes the shape and/or line to be displayed in the document window. Shape layers are not used often in digital photography. By selecting the arrowhead option on the Custom Shape tool ✎ when drawing lines, single or double headed arrows can be drawn.
Fill Layer	J	Fill layers are another type of pixel containing layer. There are three types of Fill layers:  Solid Color Fill Gradient Fill Pattern Fill Solid Color fill layers completely fill the layer with a single color. Gradient fill layers are used to create custom gradients. Pattern fill layers are used to apply a pattern to the image.

	The Fill option  is often used when creating Fill layers to reduce the Fill layer's opacity. Otherwise, the Fill layer will obscure the underlying image. Fill layers are not often used in digital photography.
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Layers Panel Options

The Photoshop Layers panel options are the icons at the very bottom of the Layers panel. The panel options for Photoshop CS and earlier versions looks like the

following: . Since Photoshop CS2, it looks like this: .

Link Layers		Link Layers. This feature is only available in Photoshop CS2 and later versions. After selecting multiple layers in the Layers panel, clicking this icon will link them. Linked layers will have the link icon to the right of the layer's name. Versions prior to CS2 use the Paint/Link column described above.
Add Layer Style		Add Layer Style. Allows you to create one or more layer effects on the active layer. Locked layers and layer sets/groups cannot have effects.
Add Layer Mask or Vector Mask		Add Layer Mask or Vector Mask. Creates a layer mask on the active layer. If a layer mask already exists on the active layer, a vector mask will be created. If a selection is not active when this icon is clicked, the layer mask will be filled with solid white paint. White reveals all. If the icon is clicked using Alt + click (Option + click), the layer mask will be filled with solid black paint. Black hides, or masks, all. If a selection is active when the layer mask is created, the selection will be used to create the mask. The part of the image that is selected will be revealed by the mask and the part of the image that is not selected will be hidden by the mask. In the mask, the selected area will be white and the non-selected area will be black.
Create Layer Set/Group		Create Layer Set/Group. Since CS2, this feature is called Groups. In versions prior to CS2, this feature is called Sets. Clicking this icon will create a layer set/group above the active layer. The active layer will not become part of the layer set/group. If you drag an existing layer to this icon, Photoshop will create a new

		layer set/group and place the dragged layer into the set/group. In CS2, you can select multiple layers and drag them to the Layer Group icon and all of the selected layers will be moved into the new group. Also in CS2, you can use Layer > Group Layers/Ungroup Layers to group selected layers or to move all layers out of a group.
Create New Fill or Adjustment Layer		Create New Fill or Adjustment Layer. Allows you to create a fill or adjustment layer above the active layer. If the active layer is a layer set/group, the fill or adjustment layer will be created within the layer set/group.
Create New Layer		Create New Layer. Clicking this icon will create a layer above the active layer. If the active layer is a layer set/group, the new layer is created within the layer set/group. Dragging an existing layer, layer set or adjustment layer to this icon will duplicate that layer.
Delete Layer		Delete Layer. To delete a layer, either make the layer active and click the delete layer icon, or drag the layer to the delete layer icon. To delete a layer effect, drag the effect, not the layer, to the delete layer icon.

Saving Images for Web and Print

Save Images for Use in Print Application

Remember to save your work often. Saving frequently lessens the risk of losing the work you have been doing. To save your Photoshop document, do the following:

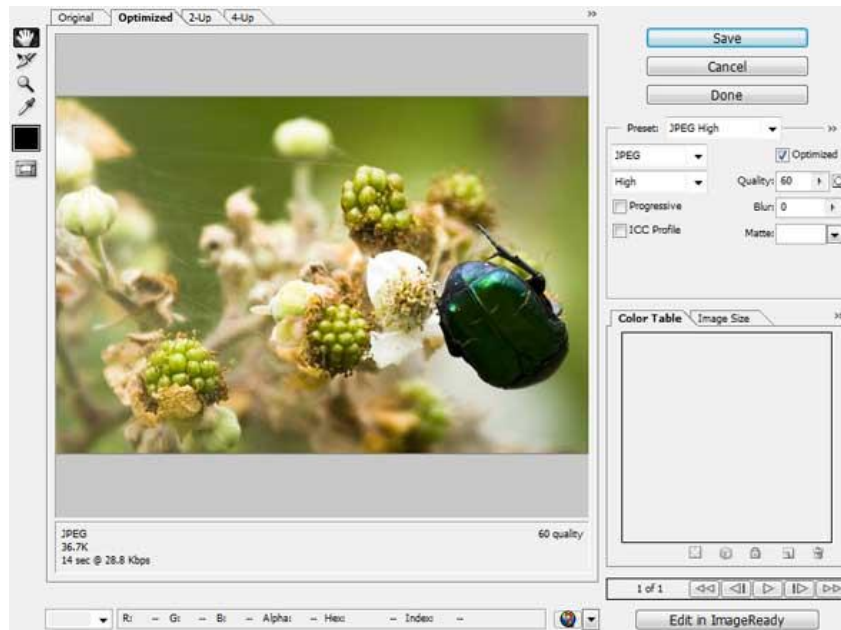
1. Click **File > Save**.
2. Navigate to the place you would like your document to be saved by using the dropdown menu and the navigation window.
3. Enter the name of your document in the **Save As** text field.
4. Choose a format to save your project in from the **Format** dropdown menu.
5. Click the **Save** button in the bottom right corner of the dialogue box.
6. Check to make sure that your document is saved in the place you intended.

NOTE: If you save your file as PSD (default Photoshop saving format) your layers will be preserved, but the file size will be large. If you save your file as JPEG (a common image format) your layers will be flattened and become one layer. The file size though will be significantly smaller.

Save Images for the Web

Adobe Photoshop has a great way to optimize images for the web. In Photoshop, go to **File > Save For Web**, or click **Ctrl + Alt + Shift + S**.

A new box will popup with all of the settings for saving and optimizing an image for the web:



GIF Images

Sometimes, you'll be required to save in a lossless format in order to best optimize your graphics for whatever you are working on. This is often seen in website design, as layouts often use far less colors than an ordinary photograph.

GIF, or Graphics Interchange Format, is an image format that uses a palette of up to 256 individual colors, making it a great candidate for web graphics that don't use a wide range of colors.

High Quality Images & Lossless PNG

PNG, or Portable Network Graphics, are lossless data formats, similar to GIF, except they support a much greater number of colors (also making them larger in some cases), and can support alpha transparency channels as opposed to single transparent pixels (again, we won't be discussing transparency in this tutorial).

PNG images are replacing GIF images more and more, mostly because they are typically able to compress better than GIF images while supporting a much larger number of colors. They are not as widely supported as GIF images yet, but are certainly heading in that direction.

For graphics that must be transported over the web while retaining full image quality, PNG is the prime choice. You'll typically result in a larger image size than JPEG when transporting photos, but at times, this can be an essential sacrifice. Typically PNG is the

better choice when a graphic contains sharp lines, or text that must remain very clear, but it's ultimately up to the designer to decide what format to choose.

Save Images as PDF

- Open your cover image in Photoshop. We are assuming that this image is completed, flatten into one layer and already in the correct size for your ebook.
- Now, you are ready to save the image in PDF format. From the Menu bar, click **File > Save As**
To open the Save As dialog box. Choose Photoshop PDF from the Format drop-down list (lower part of the dialog box). Make a note of the folder in which your image will be saved. Finally, click Save.

You will get a message about overriding current settings. Click OK to continue. The Save Adobe PDF dialog box will open.

Creating web layouts

Designing a Website Layout in Photoshop

The design of your web site should have at least three distinct parts that include specific elements:

1. Header
 - Company logo
 - Graphic banner
 - Links / buttons for the home, about, and contact page
2. Body
 - Content area for text on the page
 - Pictures or graphics incorporated with the content
3. Footer
 - Copyright Information
 - Links to policy / terms of use, and back to top link

When creating the layout design in Photoshop be sure to leave room for additional navigation, text, and site expansion in the future or you might find yourself needing to completely redesign your site because you didn't leave room for links to more pages in your design.

Steps to Follow:

1. Create a new PSD file 745 px x 600 px and save it as layout.psd
2. Place the header graphic into the document. (Open the header file (g_header.jpg), select it (ctrl+a), copy (ctrl+c), activate the layout.psd window, paste (ctrl+v).)
3. Use the Move Tool (V) to move the header to the top of the layout holding shift to let it snap into place at the top.
4. Open the Company Logo, copy and paste it into your layout.
5. Transform the logo (ctrl+t) and move it into the top left corner of the site layout.

6. Using the Horizontal Type Tool (T)  create some small text links in the sky between the two logos on top of the guide. Type the word "Home", 4 spaces, "Contact", another 4 spaces, and then "About". Text should be about 12 pt, Arial font, using the color #A6FF94 for a fun light green color.
7. Give the text a dropshadow (Layer > Layer Style > Dropshadow) with a distance of 2 and a size of 3.
8. Position the text using the move tool and the arrow keys appropriately next to the top left logo.
9. Below the smaller COW logo we'll create some larger navigation / image links:



Using the Horizontal Type Tool (T) type "HOME PAGE 1 PAGE 2 PAGE 3 PAGE 4" using Arial, 17 pt font with black text. Put about 4 or 5 spaces between the words to give the buttons some space.

1. Create a new layer  and drag it below the text you just created
 2. With the Rectangular Marquee Tool (M) select an area just around the larger navigation.
 3. Select the Paint Bucket Tool (G) and fill the selected area of the new empty layer with (#A6FF94) the green color.
 4. Make this layer look like a button by going to the Layer menu > Layer Style > Bevel and Emboss. Use the default settings by pressing OK
 5. Using your Single Column Marquee Tool delete a column of pixels between each word in the solid green background layer you just created. This will break up the bevel and make each word look like a separate button. You may need to zoom in to get right in between the words.
 10. Duplicate the green button layer by dragging it onto the new layer button  or go to the Layer menu > Duplicate Layer.
 11. Select the bottom green button layer and add a motion blur to the layer with a distance of about 150 pixels by going to the Filter Menu > Blur > Motion Blur.
 12. Move the blurred layer down about 10 pixels and lower the opacity to 20%. This gives
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a subtle line under your buttons to help divide the top from the content.

13. At the bottom of the layout create text that says ©Copyright CreativeCow.net 2008.

14. Create a new layer behind the Copyright text that will become the background behind the footer text, make sure the layer is selected.

15. Use the Rectangular Marquee Tool (M) to select an area across the bottom of the page but just a little higher than the copyright text.

16. Use the Paint Bucket Tool (G) and fill the area with the bright green (#A6FF94).

17. Feather the outside edge by using the Inner glow layer style (Layer menu > Layer Style > Inner Glow) Set the blend mode to Normal, color to white (#ffffff) and the size to 10 pixels.



We've now designed a simple, fun, website in Photoshop with a header and footer. The white space in between the header and the footer will be all the textual content and pictures that will fill in the actual web site.

Slicing Images in Photoshop for the Web

Now that we've designed a simple website with Photoshop we will slice it into pieces and export the pieces as an HTML file that can be later used and modified in Dreamweaver. When slicing your website design remember that each slice will become a separate cell of a table and image so try to keep the slices as few and as simple as possible. Make sure and start and end your slices outside of the design whenever possible so Photoshop doesn't mistake a single pixel you might have missed as a slice. Open the website design we made earlier, select the Slice Tool (K) and let's get started. (Turn on snapping for better results - View menu > Snap (Ctrl+Shift+;),

Steps to Follow:

1. Create one slice around the entire graphic. Start outside the graphic and end outside the graphic. This will help tell Photoshop to not create single pixel graphics somewhere that we don't want.
2. Slice the footer graphic starting and ending in the gray outside the layout. Let the snapping find the top of the layer for you.
3. Slice the header all the way across the top starting above the graphic in the gray and ending just below the larger navigation. This should slice the COW in two (oh no!). You should now have 3 slices for your header portion, your content, and your footer.
4. Slice out all the buttons, try to make sure you are snapping to the same position for each button so that the height of the buttons are the same. For the lower, larger buttons you can snap to the bottom of the surrounding slice.

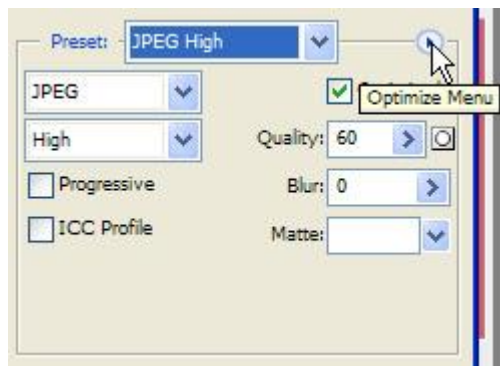


Exporting / Saving Photoshop Slices as a Web Page

In earlier versions of Photoshop saving a sliced image for the web could only be done with Image Ready but now it's all built into Adobe Photoshop CS3. The following portion of the tutorial will show you how to save the sliced website design we made in Photoshop as an HTML file with associated images.

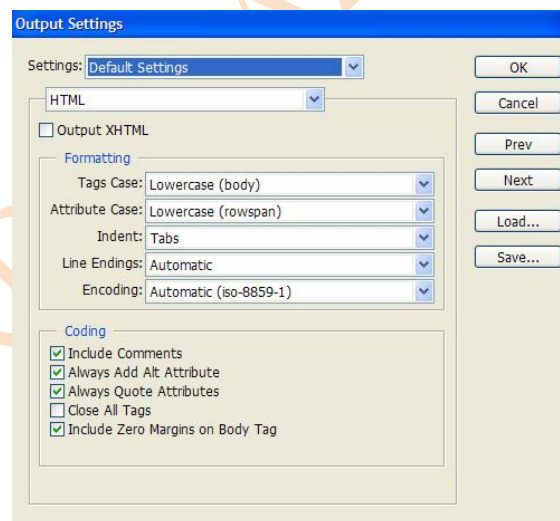
Steps to Follow:

1. With your sliced graphic open choose File menu > Save for Web & Devices (Alt+Shift+Ctrl+S). This brings up the Save For Web & Devices window.
2. Under the preset dropdown choose JPEG High for the quality and file type. (This is simply a preference.)
- 3.



4. Click the Optimized Menu arrow to open up the sub menu and click on Edit Output Settings...

5.



6. We won't go into detail on the output settings here. Choose Default Settings from the Settings dropdown. Use Prev and Next to look at all the settings.
7. Click OK and then Save. Make sure you are saving in a location you can locate easily.

8. Choose Save as type: HTML and Images (*.html)

Settings: Default Settings

Slices: All Slices



9. Click Save

Enhancing Photographs Retouch Photographs Using Photoshop Tools

Strategy for retouching

In Photoshop, you can retouch photographic images in ways once left only to highly trained professionals. You can correct problems in color quality and tonal range created during the original photography or during the image's scan. You can also correct problems in composition and sharpen the overall focus of the image.

Basic steps

Most retouching in Photoshop follows these general steps:

- Check the scan quality and make sure that the resolution is appropriate for how the image will be used.
- Crop the image to final size.
- Adjust the overall contrast or tonal range of the image.
- Remove any color casts.
- Adjust the color and tone in specific parts of the image to bring out highlights, midtones, shadows, and desaturated colors.
- Sharpen the overall focus of the image.

Resolution and image size

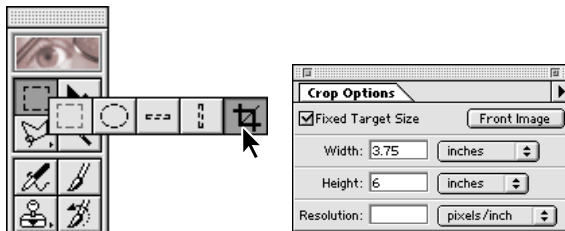
The first step in retouching a photograph in Photoshop is to make sure that the image is the correct resolution. The term *resolution* refers to the



number of small squares known as *pixels* that describe an image and establish its detail. Resolution is determined by *pixel dimensions* or the number of pixels along the width and height of an image.

Cropping an image

1 Hold down the mouse button on the rectangular marquee tool () in the toolbox, and drag to the crop tool () to select it. Then double-click the crop tool to display its Options palette, select Fixed Target Size, and enter the dimensions of the finished image—3.75 inches (width) by 6 inches (height).



2 Next drag a marquee around the image, making sure you include the top of the tower and the orange tarp in the bottom right gondola. Notice that as you drag the marquee it retains the same proportion as the dimensions you specified for the target size.

Because the photograph was scanned in slightly crooked, you'll now use the crop tool to straighten the image before applying the new dimensions to it.

3 Move the pointer outside the crop marquee, and drag clockwise until the marquee is parallel with the image.

4 Place the pointer within the crop marquee, and drag until the right edge of the marquee lines up with the right edge of the image.



Initial crop marquee



Marquee rotated



Marquee moved

- 5 If necessary, fine-tune the size of the marquee by dragging its bottom right corner handle.
- 6 Press Enter .The image is now cropped.
- 7 Choose File > Save.

Adjusting the tonal range

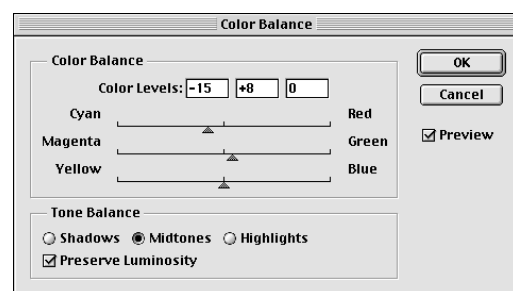
The tonal range of an image represents the amount of *contrast*, or detail, in the image and is determined by the image's distribution of pixels, ranging from the darkest pixels (black) to the lightest pixels (white). You'll now correct the photograph's contrast using the Levels command.

- 1 Choose Image > Adjust > Levels, and make sure that the Preview option is checked. Notice the histogram in the dialog box. The triangles at the bottom of the histogram represent the shadows (black triangle), highlights (white triangle), and midtones or gamma (gray triangle). If your image had colors across the entire brightness range, the graph would extend across the full width of the histogram, from black triangle to white triangle. Instead, the graph is clumped toward the center, indicating there are no very dark or light colors.
- You can adjust the black and white points of the image to extend its tonal range.
- 2 Drag the left and right triangles inward to where the histogram indicates the darkest and lightest colors begin. Click OK to apply the changes.
- 3 Choose Image > Histogram to view the new histogram. The tonal range now extends throughout the entire range of the histogram. Click OK.
- 4 Choose File > Save.

Removing a color cast

Some images contain color casts (imbalances of color), which may occur during scanning or which may have existed in the original image. The photograph of the gondolas has a color cast—it's too red.

- 1 Choose Layer > New > Adjustment Layer.
- 2 For Type, choose Color Balance.
- 3 Click OK to create the adjustment layer and to display the Color Balance Layer dialog box.



- 4 Select the Preview option.
- 5 To adjust the midtones so that they're less red, drag the top slider to the left .
- 6 Click OK to apply the changes to the Color Balance adjustment layer. Notice that a Color Balance layer has appeared in the Layers palette.
- 7 In the Layers palette, click the eye icon next to the Color Balance layer to hide and show the layer. You'll see the difference between the adjusted colors and the original colors.
- 8 Choose File > Save.

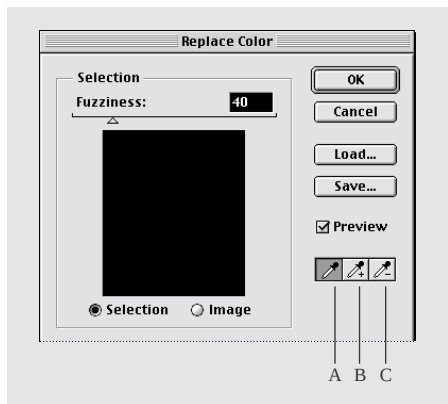
Replacing colors in an image

With the Replace Color command, you can create temporary masks based on specific colors and then replace these colors. *Masks* let you isolate an area of an image, so that changes affect just the selected area and not the rest of the image. Options in the Replace Color command's dialog box allow you to adjust the hue, saturation, and lightness components of the selection. *Hue* is color, *saturation* is the purity of the color, and *lightness* is how much white or black is in the image.

You'll use the Replace Color command to change the color of the orange tarp in the gondola at the bottom right corner of the image.

- 1 In the Layers palette, select the background.
- 2 Select the zoom tool (Q), and click once on the tarp to zoom in on it.
- 3 Hold down the mouse button on the crop tool, drag to select the rectangle marquee tool, and then drag a selection around the tarp. Don't worry about making a perfect selection, but be sure to include all the tarp.
- 4 Choose Image > Adjust > Replace Color to open the Replace Color dialog box. By default, the Selection area of the Replace Color dialog box displays a black rectangle, representing the current selection.

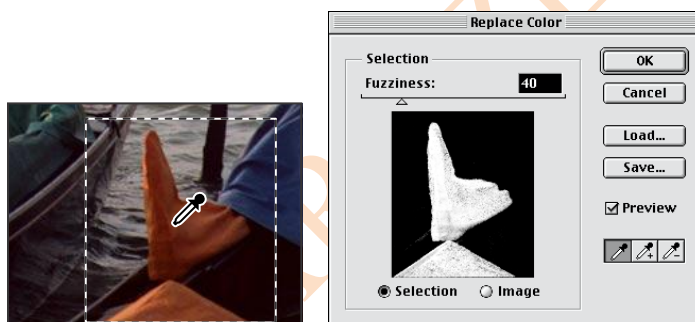
You will now use the eyedropper tool to select the area of color that will be masked and replaced with a new color. Three eyedropper tools are displayed in the Replace Color dialog box.



A. Select single color B. Add to selection
C. Subtract from selection

The first eyedropper tool (👉) selects a single color, the eyedropper-plus tool (👈) is used to add colors to a selection, and the eyedropper-minus tool (👉) is used to subtract colors from a selection.

5 Click the eyedropper tool in the dialog box, and click once on the orange tarp to select it.



6 Then select the eyedropper-plus tool, and drag over the other areas of the tarp until the entire tarp is highlighted in white in the dialog box.

7 Adjust the tolerance level of the mask by moving the Fuzziness slider to 61. Fuzziness controls the degree to which related colors are included in the mask.

8 In the Transform area of the Replace Color dialog box, drag the Hue slider to 149, the Saturation slider to -17, and the Lightness slider to -39. The color of the tarp is replaced with the new hue, saturation, and lightness.

9 Click OK to apply the changes.

10 Double-click the hand tool (👉) to fit the image on screen.

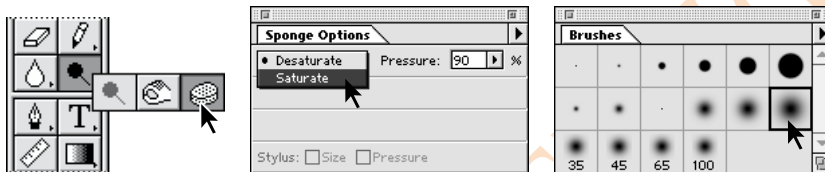
11 Choose Select > Deselect.

12 Choose File > Save.

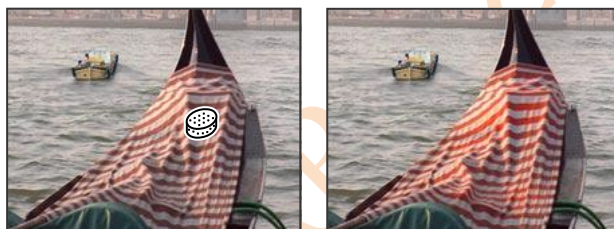
Adjusting saturation with the sponge tool

Now you'll saturate the color of the gondolas in the foreground using the sponge tool. When you change the saturation of a color you adjust its strength or purity. The sponge tool is useful in letting you make subtle saturation changes to specific areas of an image.

- 1 Hold down the mouse button on the dodge tool () in the toolbox, and drag to the sponge tool ().
- 2 Click the Options tab and choose Saturate from the pop-up menu. To set the intensity of the saturation effect, click the arrow next to the Pressure text box, and drag the Pressure pop-up slider to 90%.
- 3 Select a large, feathered brush from the second row of the Brushes palette.



- 4 Drag the sponge back and forth over the gondolas to saturate their color.



Before

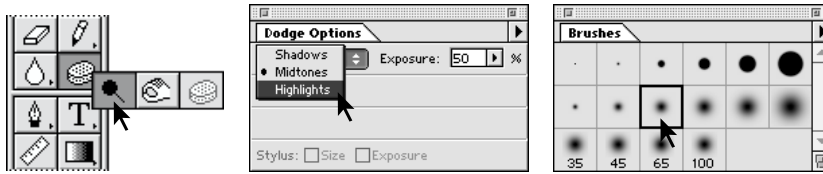
After

Adjusting lightness with the dodge tool

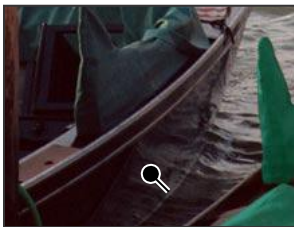
Next you'll use the dodge tool to lighten the highlights along the gondola's hull and exaggerate the reflection of the water there. The dodge tool is based on the traditional photographer's method of holding back light during an exposure to lighten an area of the image.

- 1 Hold down the mouse button on the sponge tool, and drag to the dodge tool (). Then choose Highlights from the menu in the Tool Options palette, and set Exposure to 50%.

- 2 Select a medium, feathered brush from the second row of the Brushes pal



- 3 Drag the dodge tool back and forth over the gondola's hull to bring out its highlights.



Removing unwanted objects

With Adobe Photoshop, you can remove unwanted objects from a photograph. Using the rubber stamp tool, you can remove an object or area by “cloning” an area of the image over the area you want to eliminate.

You'll eliminate the small boat near the center of the image by painting over it with a copy of the water.

- 1 Select the zoom tool; then click the small boat to magnify that part of the image.
- 2 Choose File > Preferences > Display & Cursors. For Painting Cursors, click Brush Size; then click OK.
- 3 Double-click the rubber stamp tool (👤) in the toolbox, and make sure that the Aligned option in the Rubber Stamp Options palette is deselected.
- 4 Center the rubber stamp tool over the water between the large gondola and the post to its right. Then hold down Alt (Windows) or Option (Mac OS), and click to sample or copy that part of the image. Make sure that the area you sample blends well with the area around the object you are removing.



5 Drag the rubber stamp tool over the boat to paint over it with a copy of the water you just sampled. Notice the crosshair that follows your cursor as you paint; it represents the point from which the rubber stamp tool is cloning.

6 Double-click the hand tool in the toolbox to fit the image on screen.

7 Choose File > Save.

Replacing part of an image

Because the sky is fairly drab and overcast in this photograph, you'll replace it with a more interesting sky from another file. You'll begin by selecting the current sky.

1 Select the magic wand tool () . Click to select part of the sky. Hold down Shift, and click the rest of the sky to select it.

2 Open the Clouds.psd file located in the Lesson03 folder.

3 Choose Select > All; then choose Edit > Copy. Close the Clouds.psd file.

4 Choose Edit > Paste Into to paste the clouds into the current selection. Notice that a new layer has been added to the Layers palette.

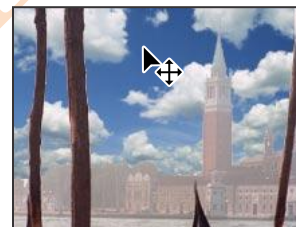
5 Select the move tool () , and drag the clouds into the position you want.



Sky selected



Clouds pasted into sky

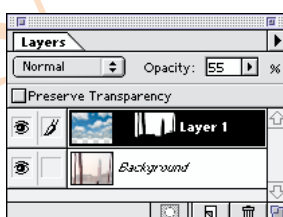


Clouds moved into position

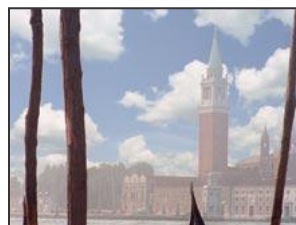
Now you'll change the clouds' opacity to make them blend better with the rest of the image.

6 Use the keyboard shortcut of typing any number from 01 (1%) to 100 (100%) to set the new cloud layer's opacity (we used 55%).

7 Choose File > Save.



Opacity set to 55%



Result

You will now flatten the image into a single layer so that you can apply the Unsharp Professional institute of computer link road abbotabad Contact No:0992331021

Mask filter, the final step in retouching the photo. Because you may want to return to a version of the file with all its layers intact, you will use the Save As command to save the flattened file with a new name.

8 Choose Layer > Flatten Image.

9 Choose File > Save As. In the dialog box, type a new filename, and click Save.

Applying the Unsharp Mask

The last step you take when retouching a photo is to apply the Unsharp Mask filter, which adjusts the contrast of the edge detail and creates the illusion of a more focused image.

1 Choose Filter > Sharpen > Unsharp Mask. Make sure that the Preview option is selected so that you can view the effect before you apply it. To get a better view, you can place the pointer within the preview window and drag to see different parts of the image. You can also change the magnification of the preview image with the plus and minus buttons located below the window.



2 Drag the Amount slider until the image is as sharp as you want (we used 120%); then click OK to apply the Unsharp Mask filter.

Create Patterns

1. Create new file with 1 pixel width, 2 pixel height and transparent background.



2. Keep Black as a foreground color. Fill the top 1 X 1 pixel of transparent background using Pencil Tool.



3. Select All using CTRL + A

4. Create a pattern by Edit > Define Pattern. Name the pattern.

Create Swatches and Gradients

Create a smooth gradient

1. Select the Gradient tool .

2. Click inside the gradient sample in the options bar to display the Gradient Editor Dialog box.
3. To base the new gradient on an existing gradient, select a gradient in the Presets section of the dialog box.
4. Choose Solid from the Gradient Type pop-up menu.
5. To define the starting color of the gradient, click the left color stop  under the gradient bar. The triangle above the stop turns black , indicating that the starting color is being edited.
6. To choose a color, do one of the following:
7. Double-click the color stop, or click the color swatch in the Stops section of the dialog box. Choose a color, and click OK.
8. Choose an option from the Color pop-up menu in the Stops section of the dialog box.
9. Position the pointer over the gradient bar (the pointer turns into the eyedropper), and click to sample a color, or click anywhere in the image to sample a color from the image.
10. To define the ending color, click the right color stop under the gradient bar. Then choose a color.
11. To adjust the location of the starting point or ending point, do one of the following:
12. Drag the corresponding color stop left or right to the location you want.
13. Click the corresponding color stop, and enter a value for Location in the Stops section of the dialog box. A value of 0% places the point at the far left end of the gradient bar; a value of 100%, at the far right end.
14. To adjust the location of the midpoint (where the gradient displays an even mix of the starting and ending colors), drag the diamond  below the gradient bar to the left or right, or click the diamond, and enter a value for Location.
15. To add intermediate colors to a gradient, click below the gradient bar to define another color stop. Specify the color and adjust the location and midpoint for the intermediate point as you would for a starting or ending point.
16. To delete the color stop you are editing, click Delete, or drag the stop downwards until it disappears.
17. To control how gradual the transitions are between color bands in the gradient, enter a value in the Smoothness text box, or drag the Smoothness pop-up slider.
18. If desired, set transparency values for the gradient.
19. Enter a name for the new gradient.
20. To save the gradient as a preset, click New after you have finished creating the gradient.

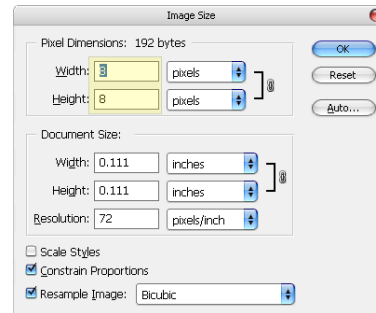
Create a Custom Brush

1. Open an image, any image.
2. Select all or part of the image.
3. Go to Edit → Define Brush Preset.
4. New brush is ready.

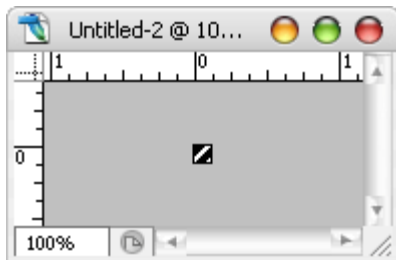
Create Custom Patterns

1. Create A Pattern Image

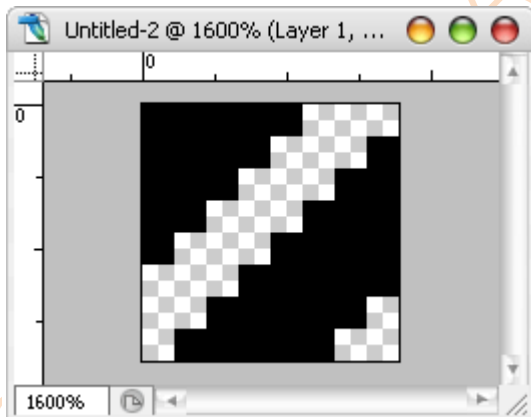
Make a new file of small size. For this example, I'll be using 8×8 pixel canvas, zoomed them up and create a small pattern like this.



Pattern at 100% view



Pattern at 1600% view

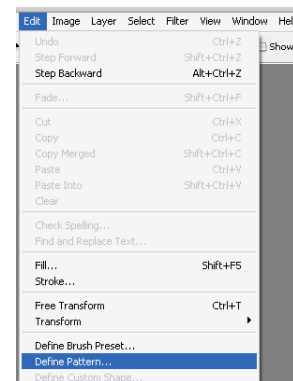


2. Define As Pattern

Let's define it as pattern so it can be used at any time.

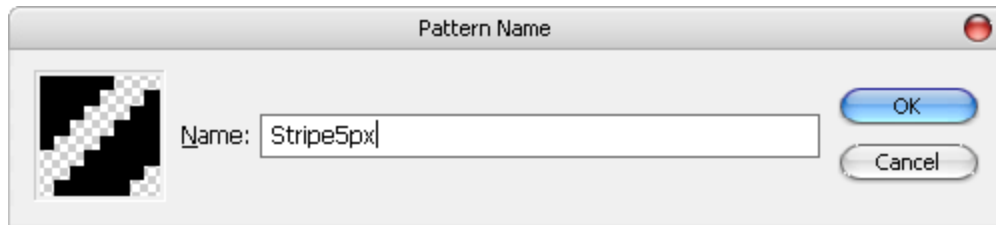
Select Edit -> Define Pattern.

Rename it to something you can remember (especially useful when you have a lot of custom patterns in future). I'll call Professional institute of computer link road abbottabad



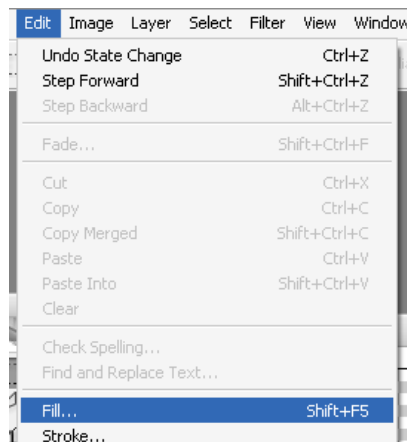
Contact No:0992331021

it Stripe5x because it will give me a stripe effect and 5px is how thick each stripes are. Click OK and you've just have your custom pattern defined.



3. Using Custom Pattern

Create a new canvas to try out the custom pattern. With your new canvas selected, Select Edit -> Fill.



In the Fill dialog box, select Pattern from the dropdown, find the pattern you've just created in Custom Pattern and click OK.

Creating Special Effects Preview Text Effects Using Layer Comps

Basically, layer comps act as a way to capture your design in different states; based on what layers you have visible. You can then capture these states, in different "layer comps" and export them as a PDF slideshow to present all your designs to your client.

Step 1

Toggle on/off only the layer groups that you want to keep visible.



Step 2

Open up the Layer Comps window, if it's not already open, click Window-Layer Comps. Click on the small icon in that window that creates a New Layer Comp (circled in the image below). Rename the comp something applicable and make sure Visibility is checked.



Step 3

Prepare your image for an alternate layer comp by toggling on/off the visibility of the layers you want to show. If you are following along, your layer palette would look like the one below.

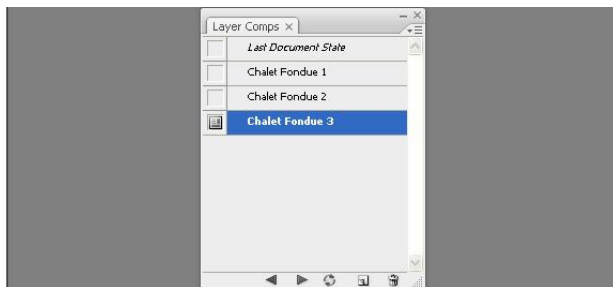


Step 4

Make a Layer Comp for your new visible layers, just like you did in step 2.

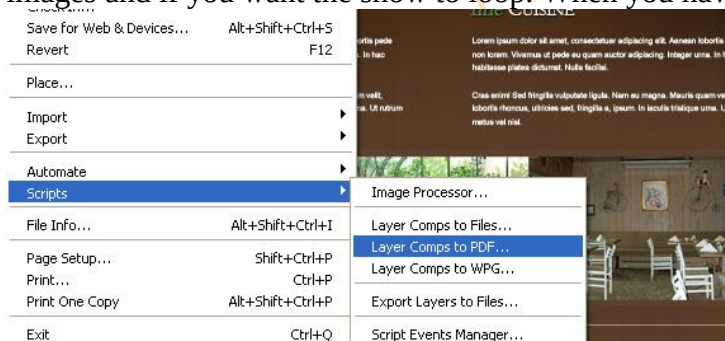
Step 5

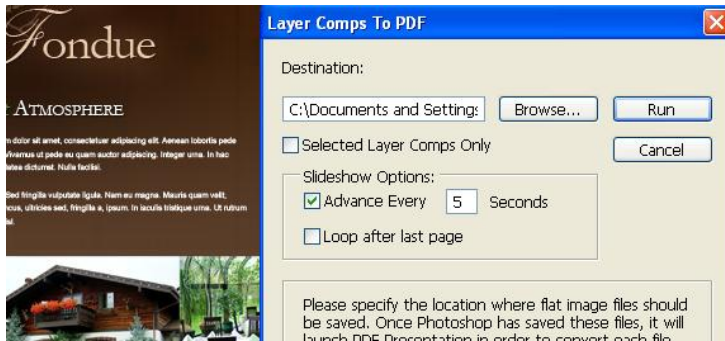
Repeat these steps, until you have three variations within your Layer Comp window. Below are the visible layers I used for comp 3, and the 3 comps within the Layer Comp window.



Step 6

Now that we have our 3 variations on different layer comps, we are ready to make our slideshow. The good news is, this is made tremendously easy through one of Photoshop's scripts. Click File-Scripts-Layer Comps to PDF. Choose a destination to save the file to, that is easy for you to remember. I almost always save things to the desktop first, and then file things later. Just makes my workflow simpler. You can play with the duration of the images and if you want the show to loop. When you have the settings in order, click Run.





Presentation Time

That's it; the slideshow has been created for you by the script! Now, you just need to find where you saved it, and give it a test run to make sure everything looks ok. Then it's time to show the client. You can email it, upload it to a server, or show them it in person. This will give them a chance to pick and choose which elements they like and dislike. Then you can go back in, make some more tweaks, then begin coding. I love this approach, it makes a lot of sense to me!

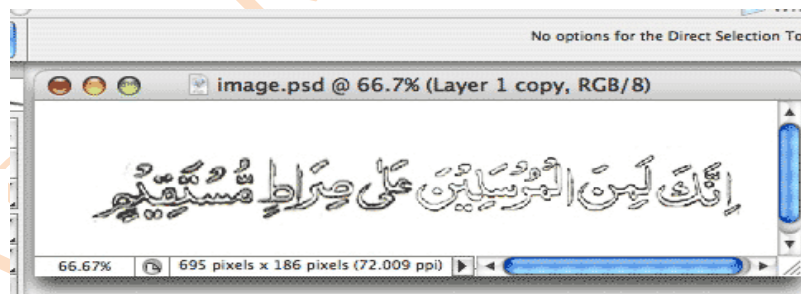
Warp an Image

Warping Images using the Warp Transformation

Create Space: Your first step should be to add enough working space around the object to accommodate the warped image.

Choose: Image > Canvas Size and add space. I usually just double the size.

I will usually also drag a copy of the image by dragging its layer to the New Layer icon at the bottom right of the Layers Palette. This preserves the original.

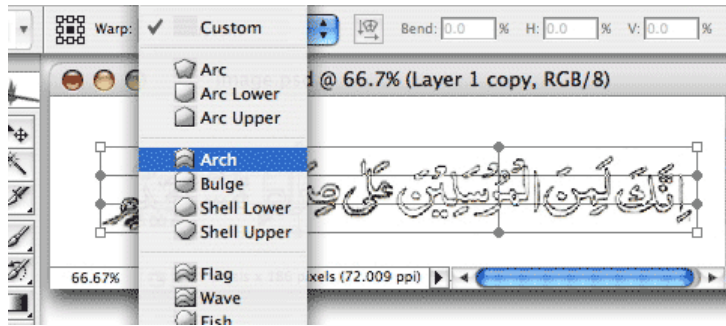


Begin Transformation: Now choose: Edit > Transform > Warp

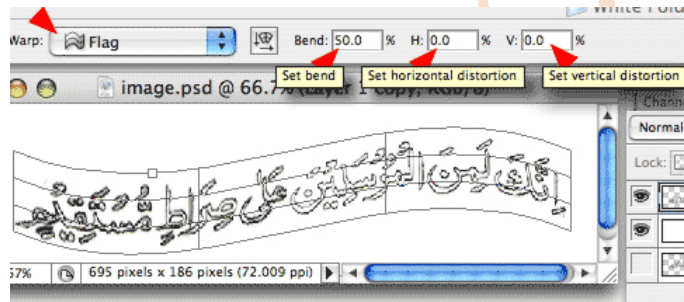
This presents you with a spline-mesh covering the image.

Select a Warp Shape: From the Options bar, note the "Custom" pull-down menu. This allows you to select any shape you wish to begin with.

Here, you can select from a lot of different shapes, and Photoshop will set up the warp mesh to match.



Modifying the Warp Shape: Turn your attention to the Options Bar and you find a series of entry fields where you can modify the shapes. It's a good idea to make a mental note of the default settings. Changing these settings will help modify and fine-tune your auto shape.



Automating Tasks Create and manage an action

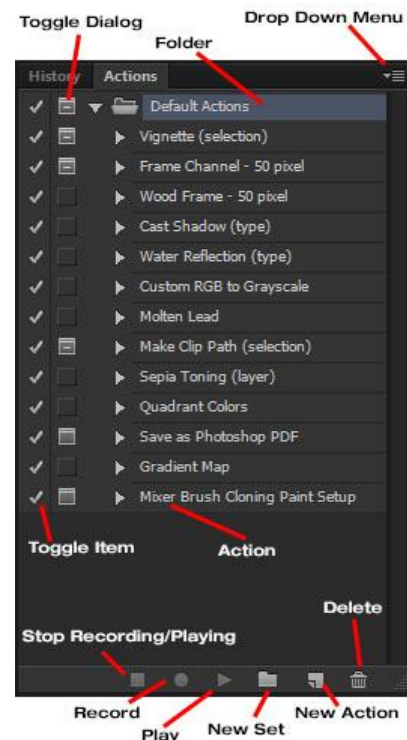
An action is a series of tasks that you play back on a single file or a batch of files—menu commands, panel options, tool actions, and so on. For example, you can create an action that changes the size of an image, applies an effect to the image, and then saves the file in the desired format.

Actions can include steps that let you perform tasks that cannot be recorded (for example, using a painting tool). Actions can also include modal controls that let you enter values in a dialog box while playing an action.

In Photoshop, actions are the basis for droplets, which are small applications that automatically process all files that are dragged onto their icon.

Managing Actions

To access Actions in Photoshop, go to Window > Actions on the top navigation panel or hit [Alt]+[F9]. This window will display a list of all loaded Sets (Folders) and Action. Here, if you click on an arrow next to the name of each Action you will see detailed steps they include. Additionally, you can create a new



folder to place themed Actions into. You can also rename each Action to your liking. However, you will not be able to rename a specific step, since it is given by the program automatically.

A checkmark next to each step indicates that the step will be performed. You can uncheck it to omit a step, in that case, that step's checkmark will disappear and the check mark next to Action name will turn red, indicating that some steps in that Action are omitted.

Dialog icon next to an Action indicates that one or more steps in that Action will have a dialog box appear, requiring user's input. By opening a detailed view of an Action you can see which step will have a dialog box. By clicking on a dialog icon next to individual step you can disable dialogs. This is often useful to minimize your input and streamline the workflow. However, this means that the effect will be less custom, and most importantly if one or more of the dialogs has a message or requires a definite choice, the Action will not complete and will stop on that step.

Actions window in Button Mode

To activate an Action, simply select it and hit Play (triangle icon on the bottom of Actions window). If you find yourself using Actions frequently during your post-processing, you can also activate a Button Mode which will perform an Action by just clicking on its name. To initiate Button Mode, trigger drop down menu on the Actions window by clicking on its top right corner icon and hit Button Mode. This will also turn each Action into its specified color. These colors are to help you manage your Actions better. You can assign color by Action types or any other parameter you choose.

Finally, important thing to remember is that an action will typically have more than one step, performing

Undo or [Ctrl]/[Cmd]+[Z] will only go back one step and will not Undo the entire Action.

To overcome this, use History window and Snapshot or File>Revert [F12] to go back to the last saved version. Personally, I create a duplicate layer to which I apply Actions, this way I can always go back to original layer or play with opacity to decrease Action's effect.

Installing Actions

If you have an Action file which you have downloaded from the Internet or just have it on any type of media device, you can easily install it. To do this, simply double click on the .atn file. This will load all the necessary information into Photoshop Actions library. You do not need to keep the original .atn file, since once it is loaded into PS Library it will be stored in Photoshop's internal Actions panel.psp file. If at a later date you will need to transfer or backup your Actions, you can do so by selecting folder your Action is in, triggering Actions drop down menu and selecting 'Save Actions.' Remember, you

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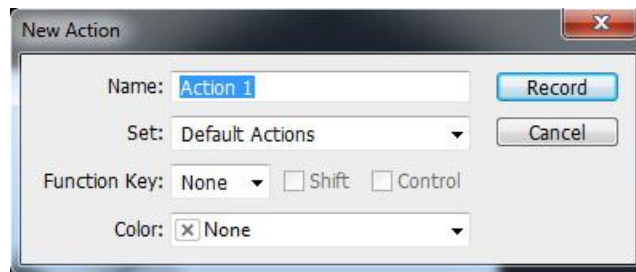


Contact No:0992331021

cannot save an Action, you can only save a Set (folder) in which that Action(s) is in. You can practice installing and running Action on your free Vivid Contrast file:

Creating Actions

If you often find yourself doing repetitive steps in Photoshop over and over again, it's time to create an Action and make your life easier. To record an Action, you first need to decide which step you would like to start from, because it and all the consequent steps will be performed



on all images you apply that Action to. Sometimes you would want to start before even opening an image, while other time you would only need to record select steps. Once that's decided and you are ready to start hit 'Create new action' icon on the bottom of Actions window. This will prompt you to name the new Action, assign it to a set (folder), give it a quick function key (optional) and assign a specific color (optional). You can always edit these parameters later, by going to Actions drop down menu and selecting 'Action Options.' Once you hit 'Record,' every step you perform next will be saved into that Action. Red circle on the bottom of Actions window will indicate that your steps are being recorded.

If you would like some text to pop up explaining a certain step, you can do so by placing a Stop. Click on drop down icon in the top right corner and select 'Insert Stop.' Write your message and make sure to check 'Allow Continue' to make sure the Action will go on playing. This is especially useful if you are creating an Action for someone other than yourself to use. Furthermore, you have an option to adjust any setting during Action playback by selecting 'Insert Menu Item' from Actions drop down menu and choosing a specific menu item. However, consider that all of these stops require user input and will interrupt automated process.

Once you have finished recording all your steps hit Square (Stop) button on the bottom of Actions panel. This will finalize the Action creation. You can add or remove steps for each Action by pressing Delete icon to erase or Record circle icon to resume recording. As I mentioned before, all recorded Actions are saved to Actions panel.psp by default and will remain in your Photoshop library. But you can also save a set or individual Actions for back up or sharing. To do so, hit Actions drop down icon and select 'Save Actions.' Remember, you can only save Action folders, even if it only has one Action. To use Action, simply hit Triangle (Play) icon on the bottom of Actions window.

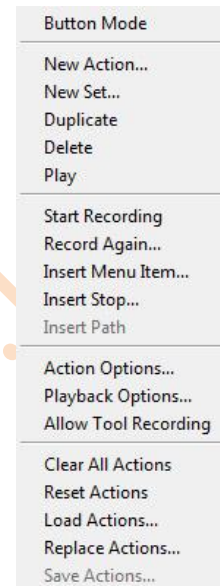
Example

One of the most common tasks for a photographer in Photoshop is Image Resize

Actions Drop Down Menu

First of all, make sure all your original files are in a separate folder and then create another folder for resized images. The last thing you want to do is accidentally resize all your images and save over originals. Then follow these steps:

- Create new Action
- Call it Resize
- Hit 'Record'
- Open original image
- Go to Image > Image Size
- Change image width to 500px and hit 'OK'
- Go to File > Save As and save the file to Resize folder
- Close the image
- Hit Square icon on the bottom of Actions window to stop recording (notice how all of your steps are listed below your Action name)
- Go to File > Automate > Batch
- Select your Actions set and then Resize Action
- Select Originals folder and check Override box
- Select Resize folder and check Override box
- Hit 'OK,' Photoshop will process images (which might take some time, depending on size of images, their amount and the power of your computer)
- You have a new folder full of resized images



Adjusting RGB Color

You can determine the current mode or change modes through the Image > Mode menu.

RGB Color

CYMK Color

Indexed Color

Choosing Colors

Hexadecimals and Color

Challenge of Consistent Color

What 24-bit Color Means

RGB Color

Color monitors generate color by mixing three colors of light (additive color) -- red, green and blue. When all colors are on at full intensity (#fff), the result is white light. When all colors are off (#000), the result is black. These three colors mix to form all of the colors in

the RGB spectrum. You can set your output to 216-colors (the Web palette), 256 colors (8-bit color), thousands of colors (16-bit color) or millions of colors (24-bit color).

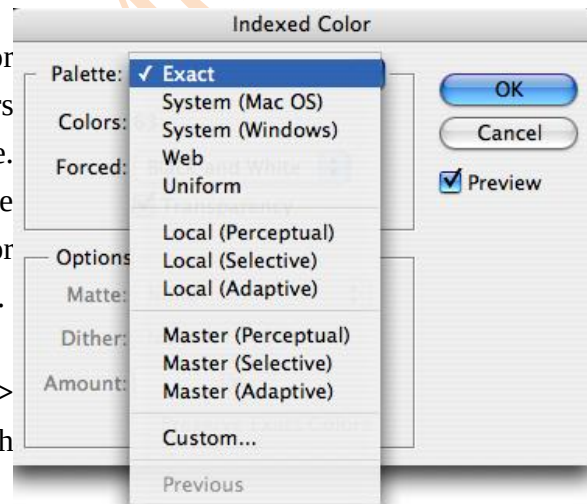
CMYK Color

This color mode is the most critical for images that are to be printed (photos, brochures, magazines, etc). Printing generates color by mixing four colors of ink (subtractive color) -- cyan, magenta, yellow, black. The Color Settings command (C*-Shift-K) offers several standards for CYMK printing. Using Photoshop for printed documents is beyond the scope of this workshop.

Indexed Color

Indexing is the process of assigning 256 (8-bit) or fewer colors to represent the millions of colors that potentially exist in a full color image. Indexing is important for creating images to be viewed on a computer monitor; the 216-color Web palette is an example of indexed color.

Select the indexed color palette from the **Image > Mode > Indexed Color** submenu or through the Save for Web dialog. Choices include:



- **Exact Palette**
What the name implies; option available only if the image uses 256 or fewer colors; no dithering.
- **System Palette**
Windows and Macintosh system palettes are composed of 256 colors; however, they are not the same 256 colors.
- **Web Palette**
The 216 colors of the systems palettes that are found on both Macintosh and Windows computers.
- **Uniform**
Creates a palette by uniformly sampling colors from the RGB color cube.
- **Perceptual Palette**
considers the color spectrum where the human eye is most sensitive.

- **Selective Palette**
Optimized for Web colors and colors that occur in large areas of flat color.
- **Adaptive Palette**
Adapted to reproduce the colors that occur most often in the image.
- **Custom**
Creates a custom palette using the Color Table dialog box

Hexadecimals and Color

A hexadecimal color code uses a six digit number to represent an RGB color. For example, white is #ffffff and black is #000000. These three primary colors are mixed to create colors that we see on a computer monitor. Although browser-safe color is less important today than three years ago, many designers stick to the palette as a conservative measure, especially if they know that their audience has older computers. You can tell from the hex color code if a color is browser safe; the color is composed of three sets of the following number/letter pairs:

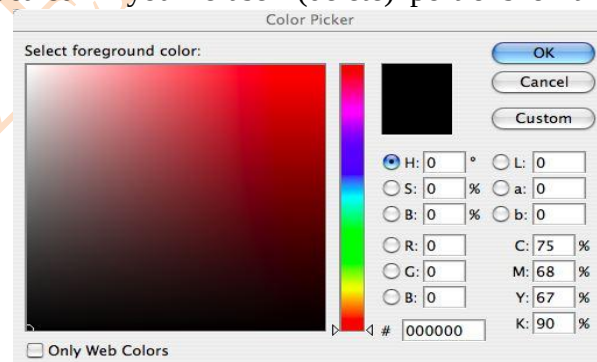
00 33 66 99 cc ff

Choosing Colors

The Foreground/Background color squares in the toolbar show you the current color settings. The foreground color shows what color you will "paint" onto the background. The background color shows what will be revealed if you "erase" (delete) portions of the image.

There are several ways to select color:

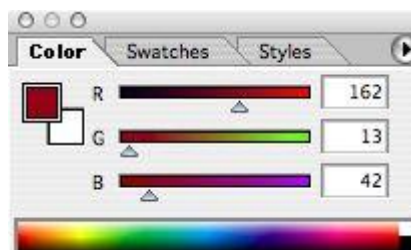
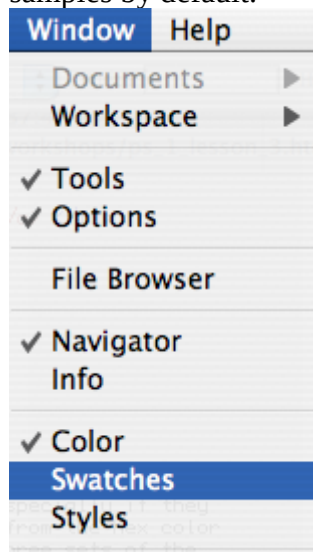
- Click on a color square (foreground/background colors on tool palette). This will activate the Color Picker. Then choose or specify a color.



- Click the eyedropper tool to set a new foreground color based on a sample from any open document. Alt/Opt-Click to set a new background color.



- Select Colors and Swatches from the Window menu. The color palette allows you to mix colors scientifically or by feel. The swatches palette show a set of 125 color samples by default.



Consistent Color

There are several factors that make on-screen and printed color appear different to the eye; there are also factors that make on-screen color appear different on different platforms and monitors.

- RGB color is additive and CYMK color is subtractive. The color on a monitor may appear brighter than the printed image.
- The gamut of color is larger for RGB than CYMK; thus, not all the colors that can be displayed on-screen can be printed.
- Input and display devices may use different color spaces (sub-sets of RGB).

- Monitor gamma differs between Macs (*nix) and PCs. Thus images appear darker on a PC monitor (default settings) than they do on a Mac monitor. This is important to know when creating Web images that will look good across platforms.

What 24-bit color means

There are 256 different brightness settings for each of the primary colors (red, green, blue) on most computer RGB color systems. Thus there are potentially more than 16 million colors ($256 \times 256 \times 256$) that could be mixed. This gamut provides enough color to realistically represent what our eyes see when we view something in the real world. It takes 8 bits (a bit is a 1 or 0; 8 bits = 1 byte) of computer data to represent each of the 256 different values for each primary channel. To represent three sets of brightness settings -- one set for each channel -- takes 24 bits (3×8).

Managing Assets with Adobe Bridge

Introduction

Adobe Bridge CS4 is a very powerful media manager letting you browse, organize, locate, relocate or view different images or files from different Creative Suite products like Photoshop, Illustrator and any other application. Besides wonderful preview options, you can additionally alter images or files directly inside of Bridge or switch between your Creative Suite applications using Bridge as a “bridge.”

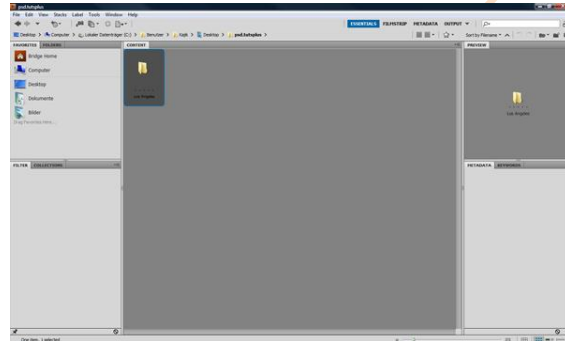
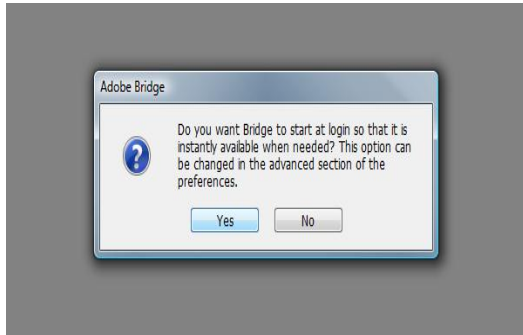
At first, I wasn't sure why I should use Bridge and how it should speed up my workflow, but after experimenting with it, I realized what Bridge is capable of. Is there a difference to the Finder or the Explorer? Yes! There's a huge difference and this tutorial covers all the features and will help make you an efficient Bridge user in future!



First Glance

When starting Bridge for the first time, Bridge asks you, if you want it to start at login so it is instantly available when needed. You can skip this option and come back to the preferences to change it later if you want.

If this isn't the first time you've started Bridge, but nevertheless want to check your settings, go to Edit > Preferences > Advanced to turn on or turn off the Start Bridge at Login option. I recommend starting Bridge at login, since it doesn't require that much speed and works fine in the background. You can then open it much faster and use it instantly.

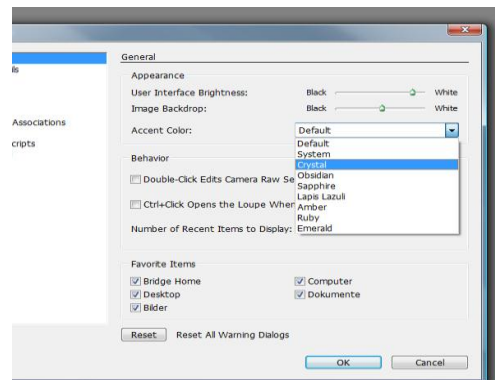


Preferences

Similar to other Adobe Products, there is a wide range of options you can enable or disable in the Preferences panel inside of Bridge. I would like to shortly mention some of the settings which I changed. Go to Edit > Preferences or use the keyboard shortcut Command + K.

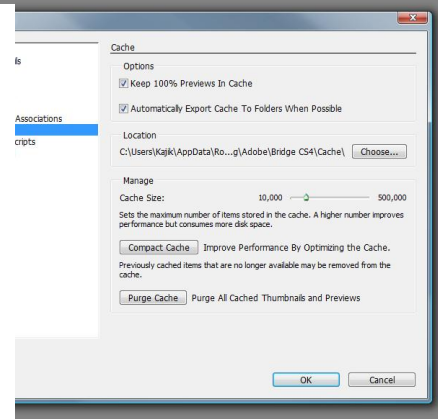
General

The first place to start is the General section including the Appearance, Behavior and Favorite Items settings. Most of the Adobe products let you alter your interface colors. In Bridge, we can change the User Interface Brightness and the Image Backdrop, sliding from white to black or vice versa. I prefer working with a darker interface, since it emphasizes the actual images and relaxes the eyes, but that's up to you. You can additionally choose between different accent styles which you can see below.



Cache

The next step is the Cache section where you can increase the display performance by changing your Cache size and how Bridge handles your Cache. Keep in mind, the higher the values, the more hard disk space and performance you'll need to display your thumbnails and image previews. Again, experiment with the settings to find what fits your system best.

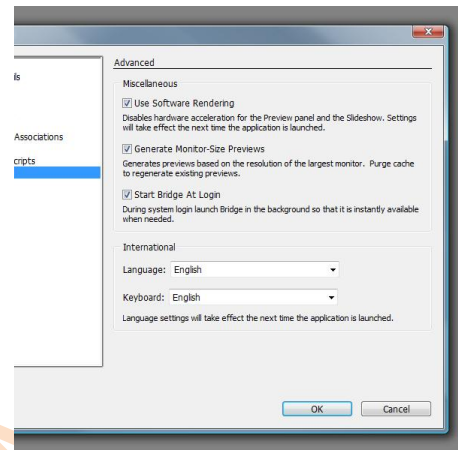


You should definitely compact and purge your Cache once in a while for better performance.

Advanced

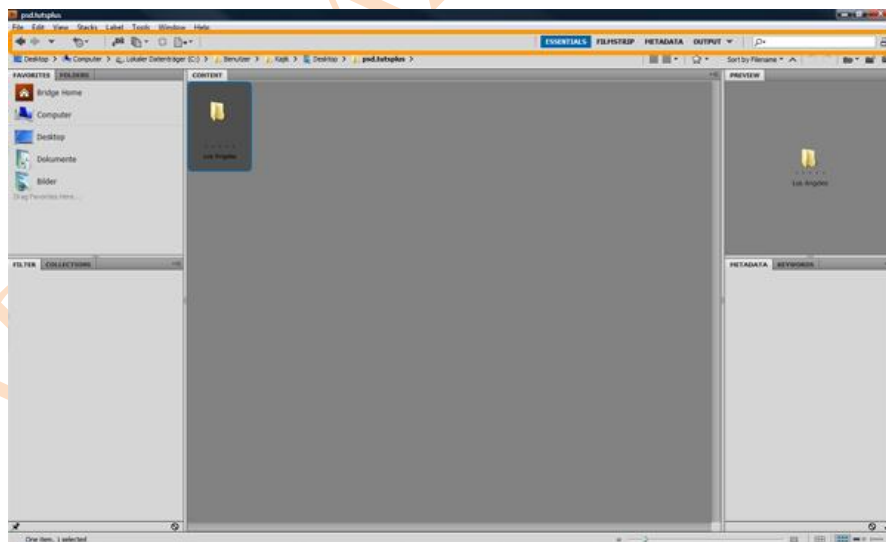
Another important section which you already know is the Advanced section, where you can change the preview settings like rendering or size. I enabled Bridge to start at login and activated Software Rendering and Monitor-size Previews.

Well that's it for now, we may or may not come back to change some options in the Preferences panel throughout this tutorial, but the best thing to do is spend some time with the preferences to make sure you utilize the full potential of your application.



User Interface, Options and Workspaces

Now, we are ready to jump into Bridge to get to know the interface, different options, task based options and much more. We'll skip the standard application menus for now and start with the options in the upper area inside of Bridge.



Go Back and Go Forward

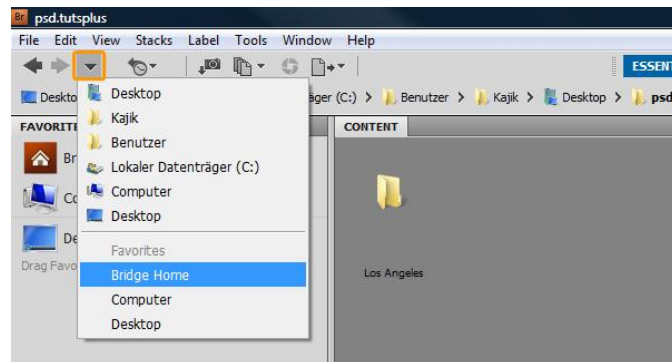
Bridge works just like the Finder on your Mac or the Windows Explorer on your PC. These two buttons will go



back or go forward one step in your file structure. You can see your file structure in the Folder panel which we'll talk about shortly.

Go to the Parents or Favorites

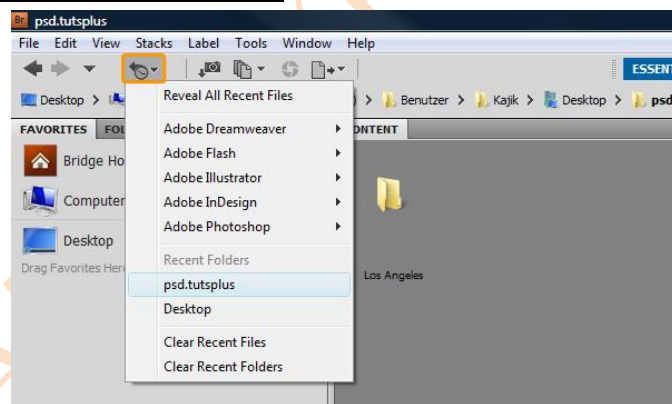
This little triangle, which points down, opens up a drop-down menu where you can instantly jump to the parent folder, where the currently displayed images, files or folders are located in or jump to your favorites from the Favorites panel.



Reveal Recent File or Go to Recent Folder

This little icon opens up a drop-down menu where you can select recently viewed files from all your applications or recently viewed folders from your system.

You can either clear both lists by simply choosing the appropriate option in the drop-down list or change the number of the recently viewed files or folders in the list by going to Preferences > General > Number of recent items to display.

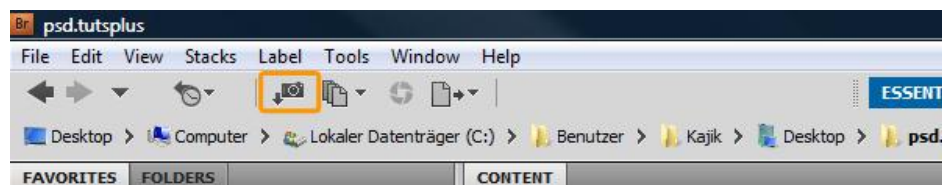


There's a little difference between displaying the recently viewed files and opening the recently viewed files. I'll show you the icon which opens up the files and folders shortly.

Get Photos from Camera

If this is the first time you are using the Photo Downloader, Bridge will ask you, if you want to download your images as soon as Bridge detects a connected device like a camera or a scanner. I recommend choosing yes. Again, you can change this at a later time. This feature is very useful and speeds up the work for Photographers or Designers who work a lot with cameras, scanners and other similar devices.

By clicking on the icon, the Bridge Photo Downloader will open, providing a few settings

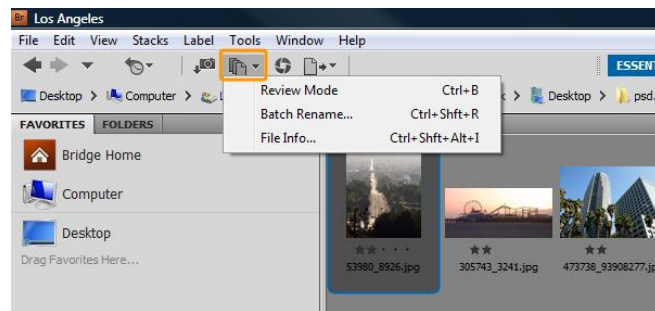


which you can change prior to downloading your images to your system. For example, you can choose your different devices, set the location where you want the images or files to be saved, rename them while importing them or converting them to other formats.

What I like about the Photo Downloader is the nice preview of the images, which can be enabled by clicking on the Advanced Dialog. By doing that, you'll be able to additionally assign metadata from templates or by entering metadata manually.

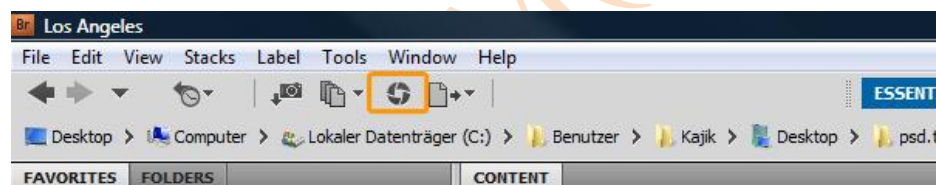
Refine Options

This drop-down menu reveals the task based options in Bridge, which we'll talk about shortly and skip for now. The options are: Review Mode, Batch rename and File info.



Open in Camera RAW

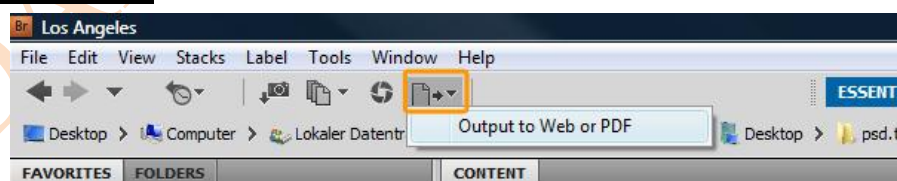
This little icon will open up your images in Camera RAW where you can edit the image



directly inside Bridge. By clicking on Done, Camera RAW will return the altered image to Bridge. The nice thing about the new Camera RAW option is that you don't have to change any settings in the preferences prior to opening your files. Whether it is a .dng, .tiff or .jpeg file type, you'll be able to open them up simply by clicking on this icon or using the proper keyboard shortcut.

Output to Web or PDF

I really like this built-in Output module, where you can simply create PDF files or nice

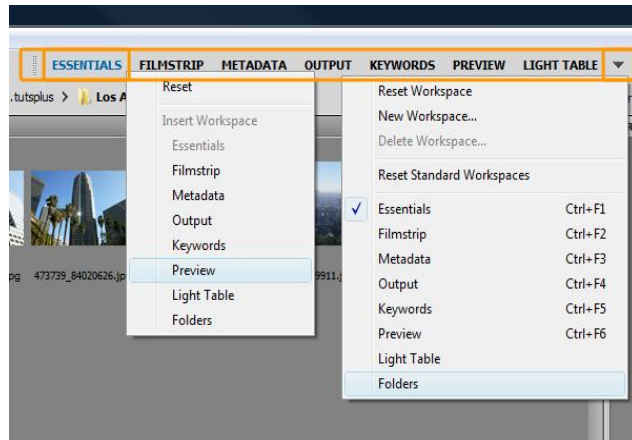


Flash galleries similar to the ones from Light room. You can choose from different formats, colors, layouts and much more. We'll talk about the Output section later in this tutorial where you'll learn how to export your favorite images, collections or selected files to PDF or the Web.

Workspaces

Similar to other applications from Adobe, Bridge CS4 is made up of multiple panels and toolbars each composing a specific Workspace. Workspaces vary depending on the tasks they were built for. Staying at the top, but moving to the right, you'll soon discover the Workspace section where you can choose from different workspaces, each prepared for a specific task.

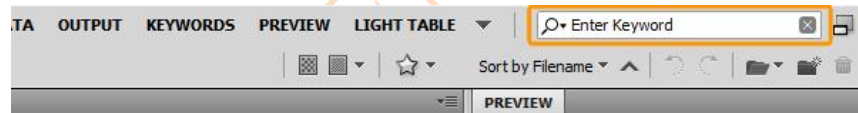
Depending on your screen size, there could be space to display all of them, by simply dragging the double-dotted line to the left, but if your space is limited, you can either click on the little triangle on the right to choose another workspace from the drop-down menu or right-click on the name of a workspace to replace it with another one. Depending on your task in Bridge, you'll often change the workspace for better control.



In case you don't like the default workspaces and want to arrange the workspace to your needs, you can do that by dragging and sliding the edges of the panels to create more space. After you're done, simply save your own workspace by clicking on the little triangle choosing New Workspace, giving it a name and saving it. It will then appear in the workspace list.

Search

To the right of the Workspace list, you can find the Search bar. The search functionality is improved and offers a variety of options besides working much faster and more



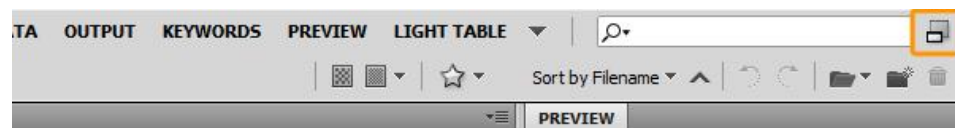
efficient. You can now search your current folders and subfolders in Bridge or use Spotlight or Windows to help find your files on your system. Applying Keywords, Ratings and other Metadata will help you find and filter your files much faster. We'll talk about that shortly.

Another very nice feature is the functionality to add other search criteria besides the name or keyword. By clicking on the New Search button, the Find window will pop up. You can now add other search criteria, change the folder and matching of the results.

Compact Mode

I really like this feature and it speeds up my work. By clicking on this icon, Bridge will change its size to compact mode which is big enough for good view, but small enough to reveal most of your screen and other applications running in the background.

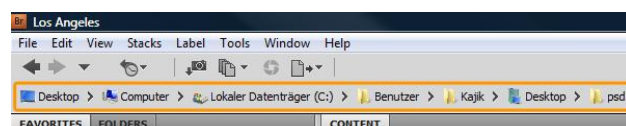
You can then simply drag and drop any image from Bridge to



the appropriate application you like. Although you can open up files by double-clicking, right-clicking or opening them through the Tool menu at the top of bridge, I prefer dragging and dropping the images or files since it is more comfortable and faster to me.

Breadcrumb List

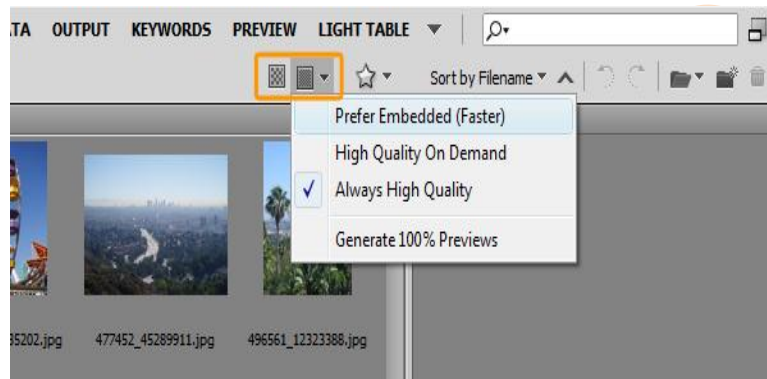
As you can see, Bridge provides a nice breadcrumb list, where you can simply



switch back one or more folders just by clicking on the name. By clicking on the triangles pointing to the next folder, you'll be able to view subfolders in the same folder or files from the subfolders. This listing speeds up the navigation and gives you a nice file hierarchy to look at.

Browse Quality

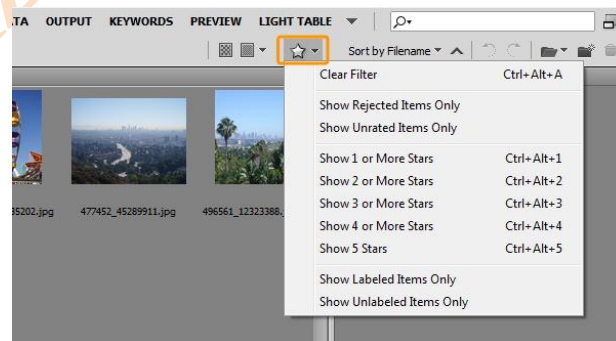
When working with a lot of images, you wouldn't necessarily want high quality images for thumbnail preview, since it would slow down your system. What you can do in Bridge, is choose to browse quickly by preferring embedded images, which you can activate by clicking on the first icon beneath the workspace list.



In case you want to preview your images in high quality for a more accurate preview, you can simply click on the little triangle next to the second icon which is the icon for the thumbnail and preview generation options. You'll now be able to change your preview quality from fast preview to high quality preview.

Filter by Rating

This little icon, displaying a star, helps you filter your images by their rating. This isn't the only way you can filter your files. You can additionally use the Filter panel which provides a lot more options you can use to filter your files and folders. We'll take a look at the Filter panel shortly.



Sort

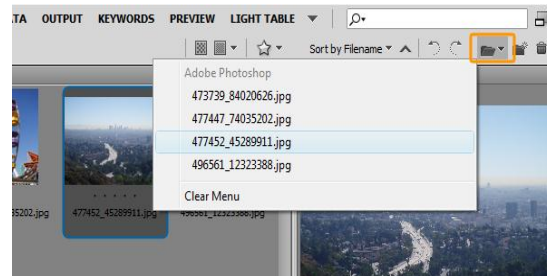
Right next to the Filter by rating option you'll find a drop-down menu where you can sort your files by different criteria like filename, type, date and more. The bigger triangular arrow represents the sort order. You can choose between ascending and descending order.

Rotate

You can rotate your images directly inside of Bridge without using Photoshop or any other application. Just click on the direction you want your image to rotate and Bridge will cover the rest. You can choose between clockwise and counterclockwise rotation.

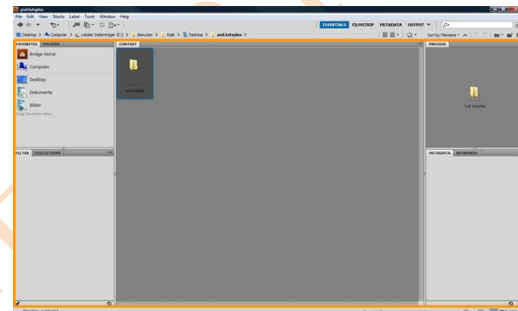
Open Recent Files

This is the other option, referring to recent files, I mentioned earlier. This icon will open up your recently viewed files and folders in the proper application, while the reveal option displayed the recently viewed files and folders inside of Bridge. You can clear this list too.



Create and Delete Files or Folders

These two icons should be familiar to you and their function is very simple. The left one creates a new folder where you can store your images or any other files, while the right one deletes all selected files and folders.

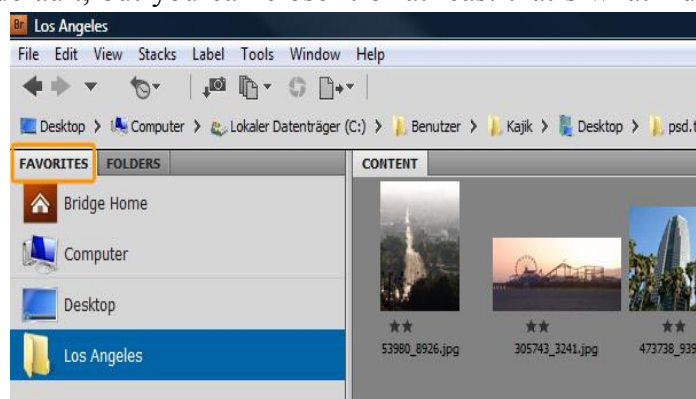


Panels

At this point we covered all the features at the top of the Bridge interface and now it's time to take a look at the different panels and how they work. As you already know, you can arrange your panels the way you want by dragging the different panel edges. By double-clicking on the Panel name, the Panel will collapse to open up more room for other panels and previews.

Favorites

The Favorites Panel is visible by default, but you can close it or at least that's what I did, because you can simply use the Go to Parent or Favorites drop-down menu at the upper-left corner right next to the Go Back and Go Forward icons to select a Favorite. The cool thing in Bridge is, you can simply add a folder to your favorites by dragging and dropping to access it much faster at a later time without having to search for it in your file structure.



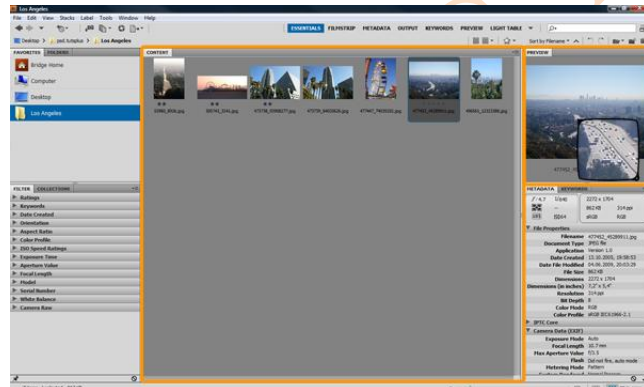
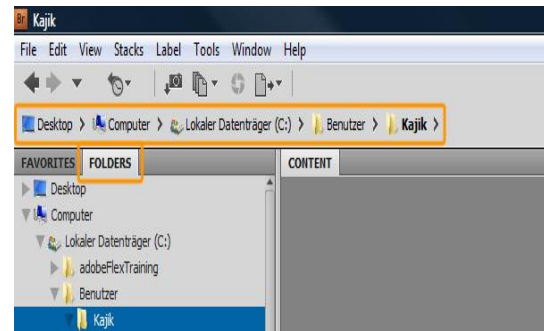
Folders

The Folders Panel is a nice extension to the breadcrumb list and helps you see where you are at and what other folders you can access from there. I'm using both, because sometimes it's faster to work with the Folders panel.

Content and Preview

These two panels are the most important panels you'll use inside of Bridge. The Content panel displays all the images, files and folders inside of the current directory. By selecting one of the images, Bridge will instantly display a more accurate preview on the right side of your screen where the preview panel is located by default.

There are multiple ways of working inside the Preview Panel like using the loupe or zooming in or out using the proper Keyboard shortcuts. Additionally you can review the rating, any assigned labels and the file name. When selecting multiple images, you'll be able to view multiple images in the preview panel and using multiple loupes for each of them.



Filter

Bridge offers you a wide range of options to filter your images and files by enabling different options. For example, choosing only images based on their orientation, aspect ratio, specific rating, exposure time, ISO setting and much more. If your space is limited, take a look at the fly-out menu to see what else you can choose from.

Collections

The collection Panel is a very nice feature and similar to setting your favorites. By selecting multiple images you can create a collection which will later contain the images. There are two types of collections. On the one side there's the User defined collection which is marked red and the smart collections on the other side marked blue. The difference between them is the way they work after you alter or delete your images.

Both collections are created on a virtual basis which means no files are getting copied, deleted or moved physically from your hard disk drive. While User defined collections are based on the selection of the user, smart collections are based on search criteria. You can always review the current number of files in the folder or collection at the bottom left corner.

For example, if you only want to create a collection containing the images with a rating of two stars or more, you'll approach this similar to searching your files. By clicking on the

Create Smart Collection icon and entering your criteria, Bridge will create the smart collection, ask you for the name and save it in the collection panel. That's it!

Now the cool thing about this is what happens now. When we go back to our Los Angeles folder and change the rating of one of the images which is not rated yet, Bridge will automatically add it to the smart collection, in case the criteria is met. This is the reason why it is called smart collection.

Additionally you can change the folder where Bridge is searching for the images or tell Bridge to consider subfolders too. Just click on the Edit Smart Collection icon on the top right corner of the Content Panel to change or add other criteria. Rerun the search to update your collection.

To create a User based collection, simply create a collection and drag and drop your images to it or select the images first and then click on the Create a User defined collection icon.

Stacking and Batch Processing

This is another very important feature in Bridge which saves a lot of time and hard work. It's the possibility to stack images which are similar to each other. To do that, simply select a few images which you want to stack, go to the Stacks menu and click on Group as Stack. You can also use the keyboard shortcut.

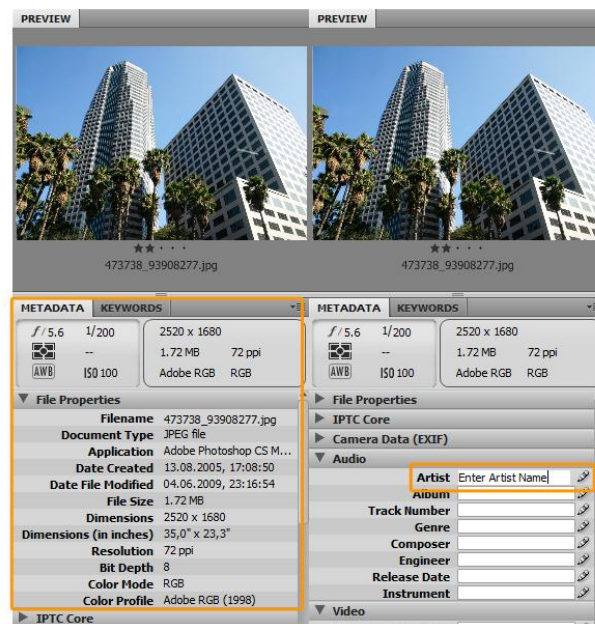
But the nice thing is that Bridge can take over. It automatically detects and later stacks Panorama and HDR images. Go to Stacks and select Auto-Stack Panorama/HDR. Bridge will then search, stack and return perfect image stacks based on these image types.

After that, you can select an image stack, go to the Tools menu and open it in Photoshop to batch process it, merge it or let Photoshop create a nice Panorama by processing it. Photoshop will automatically start, do the work and return the final image or images. You can also send the files to other Creative Suite applications like Illustrator.

Metadata

So far, we've learned how to filter our images using the Filter Panel and filter options from the tools at the top, but there's another way of filtering images and files: it's using Metadata. There are two types of Metadata: descriptive Metadata and additive Metadata.

Descriptive Metadata is the one which you can see in the Metadata panel beneath the Preview panel on the right side. It contains information which describes the image, like the type of camera used, date created, size, color mode, ISO setting, exposure time and much more. Additionally you can insert extra information directly by clicking on the Info name, instead of using the File Info option which is the way to add additive Metadata.



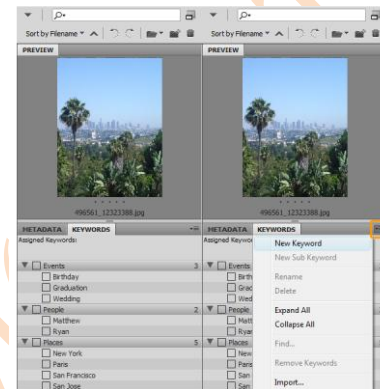
The additive Metadata can be found, changed or added through the Refine icon by selecting the image, then clicking on the Refine icon and choosing File Info. The File Info Window will open up revealing a lot of input boxes where you can type in all kind of information you want the image to carry around with it.

You can use the arrows at the top and the drop-down menu to reveal further panels. From this window, you can additionally create different metadata templates; export them to other applications or just save them to use them again at a later time or while downloading your images using the Photo Downloader.

Keywords

Assigning Keywords to your images will help you find them faster. There are several default Keywords which you can choose from, but you can create your own Keywords by clicking on the fly-out menu and choosing New Keyword.

There are two types of Keywords in Bridge: Keywords and Sub-Keywords. I personally assign Keywords rarely, since I'm not using the search form that much, but it is easy to use. After creating your Keywords or Sub-Keywords, you must select them from the list.



Preview Options

Now with the Interface, Tools, Panels and Workspaces covered, let's take a look at the task based options and the preview possibilities.

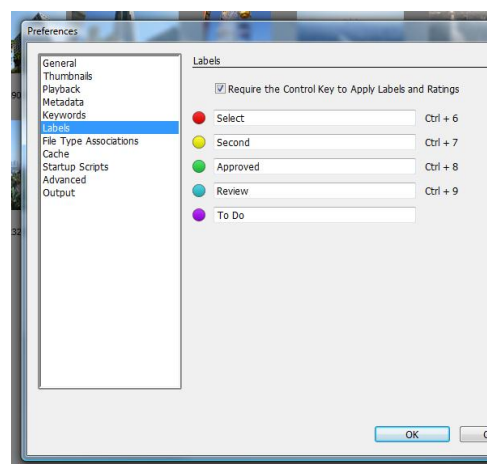
Basic Full Screen Preview

The easiest way of previewing your images at a larger size is by selecting one or multiple images and hitting the spacebar. Selecting one or multiple images and clicking the Spacebar opens up a Full Screen Preview of the images. By using the left and right arrow keys, you will be able to navigate to each image's full screen preview. Additional features like zooming in or out or moving around the current image at any time help you pre-select your images before moving into Photoshop.

Review Mode – Carousel View

The nice Carousel-style preview is accessible by selecting multiple images and hitting Command + B or going to the Refine icon and choosing the Review Mode. Again, use the left and right arrow keys to move the focus to the next or previous image. The best part is the ability to remove an image with a simple tap on the down arrow key. Note, the image won't be deleted; it's just removed from the slideshow.

This type of preview allows you to use the loupe and the zoom options. By hitting Command + R you'll be able to instantly access the Camera RAW, whether it's a TIFF, JPEG or any other format.



Camera RAW will then return the altered image back to the preview. Other than the basic full screen preview, this review mode requires a bit more power from your computer and GPU.

If you are more comfortable using the mouse or tablet just tab on the little icons at the bottom of the preview to achieve the same effects.

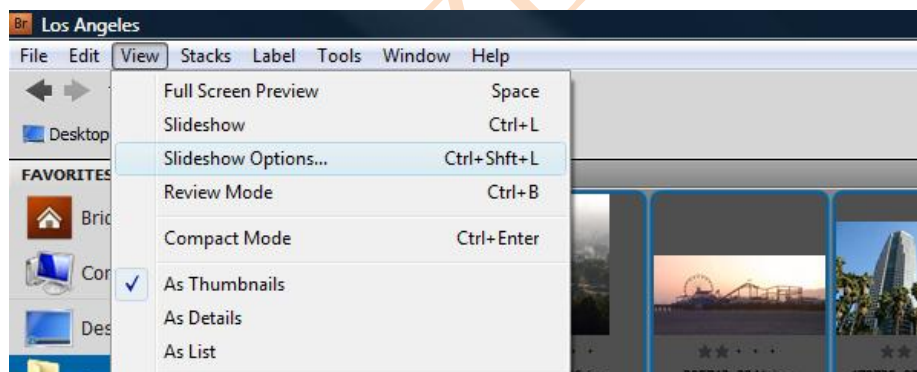
Staying inside of this Preview, I would like to introduce another tip which will save you a lot of time while pre-selecting. It's the possibility to rate and label your images using your keyboard. Depending on your settings, you only need to hit the keys from 0 through 5 for rating your images and 6 through 9 for the labeling.

If that doesn't work, add the Command key while rating or labeling. Go to Preferences, choose Labels and you'll see which label color indicates which meaning and where to enable or disable the additional Command key.

By clicking on an image in the background, Bridge will automatically bring it to the front which is very nice and saves the carousel spinning and time. A second click on the image will bring up the Loupe Tool.

Slideshow

Last but not least, I would like to show you the Slideshow inside of Bridge. The Slideshow is similar to the full screen preview, except the images switch automatically. If the standard settings are to slow or not what you are looking for, just tab the H key or go to View and select the Slideshow Options for more control. Hit Escape to quit the Slideshow.



Thumbnails

Before coming to our last point, let's look at the Bridge Output options. I would like to mention some of the best enhancements in Bridge CS4. Looking at the bottom right inside of Bridge, you'll see additional options which are responsible for thumbnail preview and how the Content panel displays the files and folders.

First, there's the good old Slider which allows a smooth and fast magnification of our thumbnails. You can either click on the small and big icons on each side or move the Slider dragging the triangle.



By increasing the thumbnails, you not only have a better preview of your images, but unfortunately some of the images get cut off at the bottom. There was no solution for that

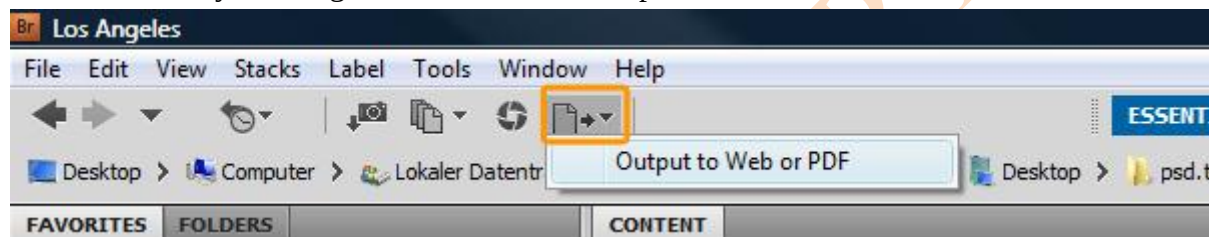
in previous versions, but now the only thing you need to do, is click on the Click to lock thumbnail grid icon next to the Thumbnail Slider. Isn't that cool?

At last, take a look at the View Content area which is also located at the bottom-right corner. These three options let you choose how the Content panel should display your files and folders. You can choose from thumbnail view, detailed view and list view.

Each one displays your files in a different way. While the detailed and list view add additional information and metadata, the thumbnail preview is the simplest and fastest. At this point, I want to remind you of the nice feature which locks the file in place and allows better scrolling through the additional list information.

Output Module

This is one of the best features and makes the end of this tutorial perfect. In this section, you'll learn how to create your own PDF files or Web Flash galleries for your clients or co-workers. Select your images and click on the Output icon.



PDF

To create a PDF file from your image selection, simply choose PDF from the Output panel and start applying your specific changes to the document format, layout or any other available option which you can see below. Preview your PDF in the Preview panel and Save it, that's it!

But there's something I don't like about this Output panel, it is the fact that it doesn't refresh automatically as you might have noticed. Remember to click on the Refresh Preview button each time you change your settings.

Flash Gallery

To create a Web gallery, the only thing you need to do is choose Web Gallery from the Output panel. After that, you only need to apply your specific settings and give it a design you like. Bridge will then create the Flash gallery and even code a nice HTML Browser ready file for you.

But one of the coolest features is the possibility to upload your final product directly to your server by giving Bridge your FTP connection information. Most of these Settings are self-explanatory, so the best thing to do is going through them thoroughly by yourself.